Supplementary appendix to: Gmayinaam VU, Nortey AN, Dzissem PE, Immurana M, Manyeh AK. Global, regional and national inequalities in neglected tropical disease and malaria burden and the consequences of development-assistance cuts: a spatial and panel analysis of GBD 2023.

Supplementary appendix

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1. Reporting checklists: GATHER and STROBE

The study produces health estimates and projections (GATHER) from an ecological observational design (STROBE). Locations refer to the main text, appendix sections and supplementary tables; items that do not apply are justified.

GATHER checklist
Guidelines for Accurate and Transparent Health Estimates Reporting (GATHER)

Item	Checklist item	Where reported
1	Define the indicators, populations and time periods for which estimates were made.	Main text, Methods; appendix 3.1–3.2
2	List the funding sources for the work.	Summary (Funding); Methods, Ethics and role of the funding source
3	Describe how the data were identified and accessed.	Main text, Methods; appendix 3.1; Table S1
4	Specify the inclusion and exclusion criteria; identify all ad-hoc exclusions.	Methods; appendix 3.1 and 3.4; Tables S9 and S25
5	Provide information on all included data sources and their main characteristics.	Table S1; Table S11
6	Identify and describe any categories of input data that have potentially important biases.	Appendix 3.4; Tables S9–S10b
7	Describe and give sources for any other data inputs.	Appendix 3.1, 3.3 and 3.13; Table S11
8	Provide all data inputs in a file format from which data can be efficiently extracted.	Study GitHub repository (data/raw and data/processed, CSV), public on publication; all inputs are publicly available from the sources in Table S1
9	Provide a conceptual overview of the data analysis method.	Main text, Figure 1
10	Provide a detailed description of all steps of the analysis, including mathematical formulae.	Appendix 3.1–3.15; formulae are stated in words with methodological references and implemented in the repository code
11	Describe how candidate models were evaluated and how the final model(s) were selected.	Appendix 3.8 and 3.11; Tables S3, S5
12	Provide the results of an evaluation of model performance, if done, as well as sensitivity analyses.	Tables S5, S7, S10b, S12, S22–S24
13	Describe methods for calculating uncertainty of the estimates.	Appendix 3.6, 3.8 and 3.12
14	State how analytical or statistical source code can be accessed.	Methods, Statistical software and reproducibility; appendix 3.15 (study GitHub repository)
15	Provide published estimates in a file format from which data can be efficiently extracted.	Tables S2, S8 and S16–S20; repository results folder (CSV)
16	Report a quantitative measure of the uncertainty of the estimates.	Main text and Tables 1–4, S15–S24
17	Interpret results in light of existing evidence; if updating previous estimates, explain changes.	Main text, Discussion
18	Discuss limitations of the estimates, including changes in methods or data sources.	Main text, Discussion; Table S13

Note. Stevens GA, et al. Guidelines for accurate and transparent health estimates reporting: the GATHER statement. Lancet 2016; 388: e19–23.

STROBE checklist

STROBE Statement: Checklist of Items for Ecological and Cross-Sectional Observational Studies

Item	Section	Recommendation	Where reported or justification
1a	Title and abstract	Indicate the study's design with a commonly used term in the title or the abstract	Summary (Methods: ecological study); title (spatial and panel analysis)
1b		Provide an informative and balanced summary of what was done and what was found	Summary
2	Background/rationale	Explain the scientific background and rationale	Introduction, paragraphs 1–2; Research in context
3	Objectives	State specific objectives, including any prespecified hypotheses	Introduction, final paragraph
4	Study design	Present key elements of study design early in the paper	Methods, Study design and data
5	Setting	Describe the setting, locations and relevant dates	Methods; appendix 3.1; Table S1 (access dates)
6a	Participants	Give the eligibility criteria and the sources and methods of selection	Methods; appendix 3.1; Table S25 (unit of analysis: countries and territories)
6b		Matched studies: matching criteria	Not applicable: no matching
7	Variables	Define all outcomes, exposures, predictors, potential confounders and effect modifiers	Methods, Study design and data, and Financing exposure and covariates; Table S11
8	Data sources/measurement	Give sources of data and details of methods of assessment for each variable	Methods; appendix 3.1–3.3; Tables S1, S11; external validation in Table S21
9	Bias	Describe any efforts to address potential sources of bias	Methods, Missing data and Financing models; appendix 3.4, 3.8, 3.14; Table S13
10	Study size	Explain how the study size was arrived at	Table S25: all GBD countries and territories were eligible; no sample-size calculation applies to a census of countries
11	Quantitative variables	Explain how quantitative variables were handled, including groupings	Methods (log transformations, per-10-percentage-point exposure, 2-year lags); Table S11
12a	Statistical methods	Describe all statistical methods, including those used to control for confounding	Methods; appendix 3.5–3.12
12b		Describe any methods used to examine subgroups and interactions	Super-region and regional analyses (Methods); spatial heterogeneity by GWR (appendix 3.10)
12c		Explain how missing data were addressed	Methods, Missing data; appendix 3.4; Tables S10a–b
12d		Cross-sectional studies: describe analytical methods taking account of sampling strategy	Not applicable: all countries analysed (no sampling); population weights used in inequality measures (appendix 3.6)
12e		Describe any sensitivity analyses	Methods; appendix 3.14; Tables S7, S10b, S22–S24
13a	Participants	Report numbers of individuals at each stage of study	Table S25
13b		Give reasons for non-participation at each stage	Table S25
13c		Consider use of a flow diagram	Figure 1 (analytical workflow); sample flow given in tabular form in Table S25
14a	Descriptive data	Give characteristics of study participants and information on exposures and potential confounders	Table 1; Table S26
14b		Indicate number of participants with missing data for each variable of interest	Table S10a
15	Outcome data	Report numbers of outcome events or summary measures	Results; Tables 1, S16–S20
16a	Main results	Give unadjusted estimates and, if applicable, confounder-adjusted estimates and their precision; state confounders adjusted for	Table 3 (pooled and adjusted estimators with 95% CI); Table S4; confounders in Methods
16b		Report category boundaries when continuous variables were categorised	Figure 6 legend (tertile cut-points); SDI quintiles in Table S18
16c		If relevant, translate estimates of relative risk into absolute risk	Excess DALYs under scenarios (Table 4; Tables S8, S14)

Item	Section	Recommendation	Where reported or justification
17	Other analyses	Report other analyses done	Results; Tables S5–S7, S12, S22–S24
18	Key results	Summarise key results with reference to study objectives	Discussion, paragraph 1
19	Limitations	Discuss limitations, including sources of potential bias or imprecision	Discussion, limitations paragraph; Table S13
20	Interpretation	Give a cautious overall interpretation considering objectives, limitations, multiplicity of analyses and other evidence	Discussion
21	Generalisability	Discuss the generalisability (external validity) of the study results	Discussion (country-level inference only; ecological fallacy); limitations paragraph
22	Funding	Give the source of funding and the role of the funders	Summary (Funding); Methods, Ethics and role of the funding source

Note. von Elm E, et al. The Strengthening the Reporting of Observational Studies in Epidemiology (STROBE) statement: guidelines for reporting observational studies. Lancet 2007; 370: 1453–57. The unit of analysis is the country or territory, so participant items refer to countries.

2. Evidence before this study: search strategy and evidence map

We searched PubMed from inception to Oct 21, 2026, without language restrictions, using six strings: (S1) NTD or malaria burden with Global Burden of Disease or DALYs; (S2) NTD or malaria with inequality, concentration index or slope index; (S3) NTD or malaria with spatial analysis, Moran's I or hotspots; (S4) USAID, funding cuts or donor funding with NTDs, malaria or mortality, January 2024–October 2026; (S5) development assistance for health or official development assistance with NTD, malaria or child mortality; and (S6) domestic health financing, displacement or donor transition. The searches identified 767 records (S1 206; S2 29; S3 163; S4 99; S5 176; S6 94); after removal of 63 duplicates, 704 were unique and 698 could be retrieved and screened by title. We excluded 602 on title and 20 on abstract (commentaries without data, superseded analyses, out-of-scope designs), leaving 76 eligible studies. The 44 most relevant and recent, prioritised within five themes, are summarised in Table E1; two landmark national studies are flagged. WHO and IHME reports were reviewed for current indicator values. Supplementary targeted searches of Lancet journals for 2025–26 comment on the aid cuts identified commentaries and letters without primary data.

Table E1
Evidence Map: 44 Studies Prioritised From 76 Eligible Records, by Theme

Study, journal	Design, data and scope	Key quantitative findings	Limitation relative to this study	DOI
A. Burden and trends				
Murray, 2014, Lancet	GBD 2013 systematic analysis of HIV, TB and malaria incidence and mortality, 1990–2013; Global, 188 countries	Malaria peaked at 232 million cases (143–387 million) in 2003 and 1.2 million deaths (1.1–1.4 million) in 2004. Child malaria deaths in sub-Saharan Africa fell 31.5% (15.7–44.1) after 2004	Outdated GBD round; no NTDs; no inequality, spatial or financing analysis	10.1016/S0140-6736(14)60844-8
Martins-Melo, 2018 (national), PLoS Negl Trop Dis	GBD 2016 subnational analysis of 12 NTDs, 1990–2016; Brazil, 27 states	475,410 NTD DALYs in 2016 (232.0 per 100,000). Age-standardised NTD DALY rate fell 45.7% from 1990 to 2016. Chagas disease was the leading NTD cause	Single country; GBD 2016; no financing	10.1371/journal.pntd.0006559
Lin, 2022, J Travel Med	GBD 2019 secondary analysis of total NTDs with EAPC, 1990–2019; 204 countries	Age-standardised NTD incidence rose, while age-standardised mortality and DALY rates fell. Tropical Latin America incidence fell from 1673.5 to 1059.2 per 100,000 (2010–2019)	No malaria; descriptive only; no inequality indices, spatial statistics or financing	10.1093/jtm/taac031
GBD 2021 Causes of Death Collaborators, 2024, Lancet	GBD 2021 analysis of 288 causes of death with life-expectancy decomposition, 1990–2021; 204 countries, 811 subnational units	53 of 288 causes (up from 44 in 1990) were concentrated in places holding under 50% of the world population. Malaria was named among the increasingly concentrated causes	All-cause scope; no NTD-specific inequality or financing analysis	10.1016/S0140-6736(24)00367-2
Zheng, 2025, J R Soc Med	GBD 2019 cross-sectional analysis of malaria plus NTDs, ages 0–19, 1990–2019; 204 countries	195.6 million cases and 43.9 million DALYs (25.0–70.4) in 2019. Malaria caused over 93% of DALYs in children under 5. Burden was inversely associated with SDI	GBD 2019; children only; association with SDI only, no formal inequality index	10.1177/01410768251321572
Zheng, 2025, J Adv Res	GBD 2021 analysis of NTDs plus malaria, 1990–2021; 204 countries, 21 regions	Incidence 4,259.54 per 100,000 (+0.56% since 1990). Prevalence fell 58.05%. DALYs fell 18.06%, from 87.42 million to 71.63 million	GBD 2021; descriptive SDI gradient; no spatial or financing analysis	10.1016/j.jare.2025.04.004
GBD 2023 Chagas Disease Collaborators, 2025, Lancet Infect Dis	GBD 2023 systematic analysis of Chagas disease, 1990–2023; 204 countries	10.5 million prevalent cases (9.4–11.7) in 2023. Age-standardised prevalence fell 55.0% and age-standardised mortality fell 72.5% since 1990. 8,420 deaths in 2023	Single NTD; no aggregate NTD or malaria analysis; no financing	10.1016/S1473-3099(25)00562-6
GBD 2023 Diseases and Injuries Collaborators, 2025, Lancet	GBD 2023 analysis of 375 diseases and 88 risks, 1990–2023; 204 countries, 660 subnational units	Global DALYs rose from 2.64 billion (2010) to 2.80 billion (2023); age-standardised DALY rate fell 12.6%. CMNN DALYs fell from 874 million to 681 million (age-standardised −25.8%). The authors warn that DAH cuts threaten these gains	All-cause scope; no NTD/malaria-specific spatial, inequality or financing analysis	10.1016/S0140-6736(25)01637-X

Study, journal	Design, data and scope	Key quantitative findings	Limitation relative to this study	DOI
GBD 2023 Causes of Death Collaborators, 2025, Lancet	GBD 2023 analysis of 292 causes of death, 1990–2023; 204 countries, 660 subnational units	Global mean age at death rose from 46.8 years (1990) to 63.4 years (2023). Mean age at death in sub-Saharan Africa in 2023 was 38.0 years for females and 35.6 for males	Mortality only; NTD and malaria results not reported in the abstract	10.1016/S0140-6736(25)01917-8
Yin, 2026, Trans R Soc Trop Med Hyg	GBD 2023 Results Tool; deaths and EAPC by infectious category, including NTDs/malaria, 1990–2023; 5 BRICS countries	Infectious-disease deaths in BRICS fell from 5.014 million (1990) to 2.574 million (2023). BRICS share of global infectious deaths fell from 40% to 31%	Only 5 countries; deaths only; no DALYs, inequality, spatial or financing analysis	10.1093/trstmh/trag115
B. Inequality and spatial analyses				
Stolk, 2016, PLoS Negl Trop Dis	GBD 2010; between-country inequality by income group for 9 NTDs, 1990 and 2010, projected to 2020; Global	Low- and lower-middle-income countries held 69% (1990) and then 81% (2010) of the burden. Burden fell 27% from 1990 to 2010, with gains mainly in upper-middle-income countries. Meeting WHO targets would cut a further 55% by 2020	Old GBD round; income groups rather than SDI; no concentration index or spatial statistics; no malaria	10.1371/journal.pntd.0004560
Lo, 2019, Lancet Glob Health	DHS spatiotemporal cross-sectional study of deworming coverage and equity index, 2003–2017; 50 countries; 820,883 children	Mean preschool deworming coverage 33.0%. Of 31 countries reporting WHO coverage above 75%, 30 showed coverage concentrated in wealthier groups	Coverage, not burden; within-country equity; no financing	10.1016/S2214-109X(19)30413-9
Emadi, 2021, BMC Public Health	GBD 2019; concentration index by HDI for 25 cause groups; 204 countries	Concentration index for NTD and malaria DALYs was −0.6872, the most pro-poor of all CMNN groups. CMNN DALY index was −0.5203	Cross-sectional (2019 only); HDI rather than SDI; no trend, spatial or financing analysis	10.1186/s12889-021-11793-7
Liu, 2023, Glob Health Res Policy	GBD 2019; EAPC, joinpoint and SDI polynomial regression for NTDs plus malaria, 1990–2019; China plus 10 ASEAN countries	Incidence rose in China (4.15% per year), the Philippines (2.15%), Singapore and Brunei. Incidence and mortality had a U-shaped association with SDI	Regional (11 countries); GBD 2019; no financing	10.1186/s41256-023-00306-1
Apeagyei, 2024, Malar J	Subnational Gini indices and time-series regression on malaria spending, 2010–2020; 40 malaria-endemic countries	In 2020, incidence Gini ranged from 0.06 to 0.73. Higher total and health-system malaria spending was associated with lower within-country inequality	Within-country inequality; malaria only; no NTDs; no between-country spatial clustering	10.1186/s12936-024-05028-4
Lin, 2025, Sci Rep	GBD 2021; inequality and frontier analysis with BAPC projection to 2041; 204 countries	Age-standardised NTD plus malaria DALY rate fell from 1506.54 to 1020.27 per 100,000 (1990–2021). Western sub-Saharan Africa held 51.18% of the global burden. Burden projected to rise	GBD 2021; no financing; no Moran's I or LISA	10.1038/s41598-025-05530-y
Khaki, 2025, PLoS Negl Trop Dis	Model-based geostatistics on ESPEN soil-transmitted helminth (STH) surveys, 2004–2018; 35 SSA countries (25 calibrated)	Spatial correlation scale ranged from 1.14 to 3,027.44 km. Strong between-country heterogeneity	Prevalence of STH only; not DALYs; no financing	10.1371/journal.pntd.0012782
Namubiru, 2025, Malar J	Spatial Durbin, SLX and SDEM models plus fixed effects with Driscoll–Kraay errors, 2010–2022; 38 SSA countries	Moran's I showed significant clustering of malaria cases and deaths in every year. DAH per capita was positively associated with burden, reflecting targeting. Spillover between neighbours was limited	Malaria only; SSA only; WHO/MAP outcomes rather than GBD DALYs; no NTDs	10.1186/s12936-025-05592-3

Study, journal	Design, data and scope	Key quantitative findings	Limitation relative to this study	DOI
Feng, 2025, BMC Infect Dis	GBD 2021; concentration index and slope index of inequality by SDI, decomposition, BAPC projection to 2050; 204 countries	1990–2021: age-standardised incidence +0.59%; prevalence −58.05%; deaths −25%; DALY rate −32.36%. Absolute inequality narrowed while relative inequality worsened	GBD 2021; no spatial autocorrelation; no financing	10.1186/s12879-025-12068-x
Cao, 2026, JAMA Dermatol	GBD Foresight DALYs; Skin NTDs SDG Index, 2020–2030; Global, national	Only 11 countries were on track to meet the 75% DALY-reduction target for one skin NTD. Government share of health spending was linked to better progress	Skin NTDs only; foresight model rather than observed trends; no external-financing exposure	10.1001/jamadermatol.2025.6135
C. Financing and outcomes				
Mishra, 2009, J Health Econ	Cross-country panel, 1973–2004; 118 countries	Doubling health aid per capita was associated with a 2% lower infant mortality rate	Infant mortality only; old data; no malaria or NTDs	10.1016/j.jhealeco.2009.05.004
Flaxman, 2010, PLoS Med	Bayesian compartmental model of ITN coverage plus regression on malaria DAH, 2000–2008; 44 African countries	Each US$1 per capita of malaria DAH was associated with +5.3 percentage points ITN ownership (3.7–6.9) and +4.6 percentage points ITN use in under-5s (2.5–6.7)	Coverage outcome, not burden; malaria only	10.1371/journal.pmed.1000328
Akachi, 2011, PLoS One	Panel regression plus Lives Saved Tool, 2002–2008; 34 SSA countries	US$1 million of malaria ODA bought 50,478 ITNs. 1,000 ITNs saved 0.625 lives. Global Fund-supported ITN/IRS averted about 240,000 deaths. High-burden countries received less ODA per person at risk (US$3.90 vs US$7.05)	Child mortality only; SSA only; pre-2010	10.1371/journal.pone.0021309
Bendavid, 2014, JAMA Intern Med	Cross-country panel with country and year fixed effects, 1974–2010; 140 countries	Each 1% increase in health aid was linked to +0.24 months of life expectancy (0.02–0.46) and a 0.14 per 1,000 faster decline in under-5 mortality. US$1 billion was linked to 364,800 fewer under-5 deaths (98,400–630,000)	All-cause outcomes; no NTD or malaria burden; no spatial dependence	10.1001/jamainternmed.2014.292
Hsiao, 2014, J Epidemiol Glob Health	Panel with country and period fixed effects, plus GMM; 120 LMICs	Malaria DAH and HIV DAH were associated with lower malaria and HIV mortality. TB DAH showed no association	No NTDs; no DALYs; pre-2014; no inequality	10.1016/j.jegh.2014.10.001
Yan, 2015, BMC Public Health	Econometric panel with fixed effects, 1995–2010; All Global Fund-eligible countries	Each +US$10 per capita of Global Fund disbursement was linked to a 1.4% per year faster decline in adult mortality and a 6.9% per year faster decline in under-5 malaria mortality. No association with all-cause under-5 mortality	One donor; ends 2010; no NTDs	10.1186/s12889-015-2305-1
Dolan, 2019 (national), PLoS One	Geospatial difference-in-differences on DHS 2007 and 2013–14 (52,656 children); DRC	The LLIN campaign reduced under-5 mortality by 41% (3.7 percentage points, 1.3–6.0) in rural areas with high malaria ecology	Single country; one intervention	10.1371/journal.pone.0212890
Weiss, 2022, Popul Health Metr	Synthetic control analysis of USAID maternal and child health funding, 2000–2016; LMICs with high USAID support	Under-5 mortality was on average 29 per 1,000 lower than the synthetic control (yearly range −2 to −38)	Child mortality only; no NTDs or malaria	10.1186/s12963-021-00278-9
Sempungu, 2023, Glob Public Health	GBD 2019 joinpoint plus two-way fixed effects (DAH and governance), 2000–2017; Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria age-standardised DALY rate fell 47% (UI −69 to −14). DAH coefficient on that rate was −134.18 (SE 27.26); governance coefficient −246.19	Malaria only; SSA only; DAH level rather than dependence share; no NTDs or spatial terms	10.1080/17441692.2023.2229892

Study, journal	Design, data and scope	Key quantitative findings	Limitation relative to this study	DOI
Apeagyei, 2024, Malar J	Malaria spending estimates (11 programme areas) plus stochastic frontier and regression, 2000–2020; All malaria-endemic countries	A higher share of malaria spending from donors, or on prevention, was associated with higher incidence efficiency	Efficiency rather than burden elasticity; malaria only	10.1186/s12936-024-05165-w
Gibson, 2025, Lancet Glob Health	Panel difference-in-differences of aid sanctions with fixed effects and country trends, 1990–2019; 67 sanctioned vs 66 never-sanctioned LMICs	Sanctions cut DAH by US$16.42 million a year (−17%). They added 129.3 infant deaths and 10.9 maternal deaths per 100,000 live births each year, raising infant mortality 3.1%, under-5 mortality 3.6% and maternal mortality 6.4%	Maternal and child mortality only; no NTD or malaria burden	10.1016/S2214-109X(25)00058-0
Shi, 2025, China CDC Wkly	Panel analysis of donor funding against the malaria prevention and control cascade, 2011–2022; 26 African countries	About 70% of malaria funding came from global assistance. US$7.15 billion was disbursed 2011–2020, 94.65% from the USA and the Global Fund. Funding was only weakly correlated with cascade coverage	Service coverage, not burden; malaria only	10.46234/ccdcw2025.103
D. Projections of funding cuts				
Hallett, 2025, Lancet	Disease-specific epidemiological and costing models for 2027–29; Global Fund-eligible countries	Need US$140.6 billion; US$111.3 billion (79%) available. Optimal use could save 23 million lives and avert 400 million cases. Return of up to US$19 per US$1	HIV, TB and malaria only; no NTDs; investment case rather than cut scenario	10.1016/S0140-6736(25)00831-1
Symons, 2025, Lancet	Geospatial Bayesian transmission model with and without PMI commodities, 2025; 27 African PMI focus countries	PMI would avert 13.6 million cases (11.4–16.4 million) and 104,000 deaths (69,000–161,000) in 2025, equal to 11.3% of malaria morbidity and 37.5% of malaria mortality in PMI geographies	Malaria only; one year; one donor; no NTDs	10.1016/S0140-6736(25)00805-0
Stover, 2025, Lancet Glob Health	Established mathematical models (6 HIV models, 1 TB, 1 MCH, 3 family-planning approaches), 2025–2030; Up to 80 countries	Full cessation of US funding: 4.1 million AIDS deaths (1.6–6.6 million), 606,900 TB deaths, and 2.5 million (1.3–4.5 million) other child deaths	No malaria or NTD outcomes	10.1016/S2214-109X(25)00281-5
C. Financing and outcomes				
Cavalcanti, 2025, Lancet	Fixed-effects Poisson panel (2001–2021) plus microsimulation to 2030; 133 countries	USAID funding linked to lower mortality: all-cause RR 0.85 (0.78–0.93); malaria RR 0.49 (0.39–0.61; 8.0 million deaths averted); NTDs RR 0.50 (0.40–0.62; 8.9 million). Cuts projected to cause 14.05 million extra deaths by 2030 (8.48–19.66 million), 4.54 million under age 5	One donor; mortality only (no DALYs or disability-dominated NTD burden); no country-level NTD projections; no spatial structure	10.1016/S0140-6736(25)01186-9
da Silva, 2026, Lancet Glob Health	Two-way fixed-effects Poisson panel of ODA (2002–2021) plus microsimulation of 3 scenarios to 2030; 93 LMICs	Higher ODA linked to lower mortality: all-cause RR 0.77 (0.70–0.85); malaria RR 0.44 (0.35–0.56); NTDs RR 0.46 (0.36–0.59). Severe defunding: 22.6 million extra deaths (16.3–29.3 million). Mild defunding: 9.4 million (6.2–12.6 million) by 2030	Mortality only; ODA level rather than financing-dependence share; no separation of between- and within-country variation; no NTD DALYs	10.1016/S2214-109X(26)00008-2
E. Domestic financing, displacement and donor transition				
Liese, 2009, Int Health	Analysis of ODA commitments, 2003–2007; DAC and multilateral donors	Only 0.6% of health ODA went to NTDs, compared with HIV/AIDS 36.3%, malaria 3.6% and TB 2.2%	Descriptive; old; no outcomes	10.1016/j.inhe.2009.08.004

Study, journal	Design, data and scope	Key quantitative findings	Limitation relative to this study	DOI
Lordan, 2011, Soc Sci Med	Regression on recipient-year DAH panel; Aid recipients	HIV/AIDS DAH displaced malaria DAH (a large effect) and health-sector DAH, but not TB DAH	Displacement between donor flows, not domestic; no burden outcomes	10.1016/ j.socscimed.2011.05.045
Shretta, 2017, Malar J	IHME DAH plus government expenditure tracking, 1990–2017; 35 malaria-eliminating countries	Malaria DAH fell from US$176 million (2010) to US$62 million (2013). The Global Fund provided 96% of external malaria funding in 2013. Domestic spending did not keep pace	Low-burden countries; descriptive	10.1186/s12936-017-1890-0
GBD Health Financing Collaborator Network, 2019, Lancet	Health spending by source, 1995–2016, projected to 2050; 195 countries	Low-income countries had 0.4% of global health spending in 2016 but 10.0% of the population. HIV/AIDS received US$9.5 billion (24.3%) of DAH in 2018	No burden outcomes; no NTD-specific flows	10.1016/S0140-6736(19)30841-4
Patenaude, 2021, Health Policy Plan	Arellano–Bond system GMM on DAH, domestic spending and under-5 mortality, 2000–2015; 134 countries	DAH had no significant effect on overall domestic public health spending. US$1 of on-budget DAH raised government HIV spending by US$0.12. A 1% rise in public financing cut under-5 mortality by 0.025%; DAH had no significant effect	Under-5 mortality only; no NTD or malaria burden	10.1093/heapol/czab004
Huffstetler, 2022, Health Policy Plan	Scoping review of donor transitions, 1990–2018 (89 of 11,236 records); Middle-income countries	Unmanaged transitions led to funding shortfalls, stock-outs, service disruption and workforce gaps	Qualitative synthesis; no quantified burden	10.1093/heapol/czac063
Apeagyei, 2025, Lancet	IHME DAH tracking with forecasts, 1990–2030; Global	DAH peaked at US$80.3 billion (2021), fell to US$49.6 billion (2024), was estimated at US$38.4 billion for 2025 (range 36.8–40.0), and is forecast at US$36.2 billion for 2030	Financing only; no health-loss estimates	10.1016/S0140-6736(25)01240-1

Note. PubMed searched from inception to Oct 21, 2026 (six search strings; 767 records, 704 unique, 698 screened by title, 96 abstracts assessed, 76 eligible). Themes may overlap; studies are listed under their first theme. Values are as reported in each abstract.

Other eligible studies (not tabulated)

Theme A (GBD 2019/2021 NTD and malaria descriptive studies): Huang 2026 (42205429); Li 2025 (41529013); Tuergan 2025 (40670079); Chen 2025 (40197173); Lv 2024 (39090572); Li 2025, leishmaniasis (41291776); Wang 2026 (42506771); Liu 2025 (40247186); Huang 2025 (40097534); Shi 2023 (37396933); Liu 2021 (33763689); de Vlas 2016 (26890362); Turner 2022 (35643508); Downs 2025 (40747453).

Theme B: He 2025 (40773432); Zhao 2025 (40300002); Schmidt 2022 (36068517); Rocha 2023, Brazil (37881800).

Theme C: Kim 2022 (36360980); de Jongh 2013 (23921987); Korenromp 2013 (23317000); Snow 2010 (20889199); Negeri 2016 (27103844); Negeri 2023 (37347062); Jaupart 2019 (31908857).

Theme E: Liese 2014 (25096331); Ravishankar 2009 (19541038); Dieleman 2016 (27086170); GBD Health Financing Collaborator Network 2020 (32334655); Stürenburg 2026 (42613327); Xie 2025 (39800386); Kolesar 2023 (37640489).

3. Detailed statistical methods

This section gives the full specification of every analysis summarised in the main text. Formulae are described in words.

3.1 Data sources, linkage and study populations

We conducted an ecological panel study of 204 countries and territories in seven Global Burden of Disease (GBD) super-regions, covering 2005–2023. We described the burden of neglected tropical diseases (NTDs) and malaria, assessed spatial clustering and socioeconomic inequality, examined associations with external health financing, and modelled potential health losses under reductions in development assistance for health (DAH). The unit of analysis was the country-year; estimates therefore describe population-level associations rather than individual effects (Morgenstern, 1995). Reporting followed the Guidelines for Accurate and Transparent Health Estimates Reporting (GATHER) and relevant STROBE recommendations (Stevens et al., 2016; von Elm et al., 2007). The GATHER checklist is provided in the appendix.

We linked five public sources: GBD 2023, World Bank World Development Indicators (WDI), World Health Organization (WHO) indicators disseminated through the UN Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) database, Institute for Health Metrics and Evaluation (IHME) Financing Global Health estimates, and Natural Earth boundaries (Apeagyei et al., 2025; GBD 2023 Disease and Injury and Risk Factor Collaborators, 2025; United Nations Statistics Division, n.d.; World Bank, n.d.; World Health Organization, n.d.). Records were harmonised using ISO 3166-1 alpha-3 codes, GBD location identifiers and the GBD super-region hierarchy. Table S1 summarises source coverage; Figure 1 shows the analytical workflow.

Descriptive analyses covered 204 GBD locations. Spatial analyses included 203 locations with Natural Earth polygons, excluding Tokelau. Financing analyses began with 168 locations outside the GBD high-income super-region; this geographical classification is not equivalent to World Bank low- and middle-income status. After covariate exclusions, the NTD panel included 153 locations. Malaria models additionally required a maximum age-standardised malaria DALY rate above 10 per 100 000 during 2005–2023: 78 locations met this threshold and 77 entered the complete-case panel. Inequality analyses required population data; the original Theil analysis also excluded zero-rate locations. Inequality time series used all 204 locations, weighted by GBD population for 1990 and by population implied by GBD all-age counts divided by crude rates for 2010 and 2023.

Countries were assigned to the 21 GBD regions using the GBD location hierarchy. Summed country DALY counts reproduced published regional totals to within 0.2% in 17 regions and within 1.5–4.2% in the Caribbean, Central Europe, Western Europe and Oceania, where GBD regional aggregates include locations without separate country estimates. In the linkage file, Finland carried the Natural Earth code for the Åland Islands (ALA); it was reassigned to Western Europe for regional analyses and to the Finland polygon for supplementary maps.

WHO-reported indicators provided outcomes not obtained from GBD: the number of people requiring NTD interventions (SDG 3.3.5) and malaria incidence per 1000 people at risk (SDG 3.3.3) (United Nations Statistics Division, n.d.; World Health Organization, 2020). These were retrieved through the UN SDG database. IHME Financing Global Health estimates for 1990–2030 were used to calibrate the funding-cut scenarios (Apeagyei et al., 2025). Estimated DAH fell from US$49.6 billion in 2024 to a preliminary US$38.4 billion in 2025, approximately 22%. Spatial analyses used Natural Earth administrative level 0 polygons at 1:50 million scale (Natural Earth, n.d.). After projection to Robinson coordinates (ESRI:54030), the scripts generated an interior representative point for each country polygon. Euclidean distances between these points defined the original spatial weights. GBD extracts were retained as raw CSV and JSON files; WDI and SDG series were retrieved through public APIs. Truncated requests were split into shorter year windows, and country-year coverage was checked after assembly. The GBD outcome panel contained 3876 observations (204 locations × 19 years), with no missing outcomes. Raw data, processed datasets and scripts are archived with the paper. Natural Earth records with missing ISO codes were matched using administrative codes. The supplied WDI extract covered 2005–2024; the panel retained 2005–2023. Table S11 lists indicator codes, definitions, transformations and lags.

3.2 Burden outcomes

GBD 2023 supplied annual all-age DALY counts and age-standardised DALY rates for the combined NTD-and-malaria category and malaria during 2005–2023. NTD totals excluding malaria were obtained by subtraction. The 2023 cross-section additionally contained 19 individual NTD components, selected deaths and prevalence estimates, and published uncertainty intervals (UIs). The 19 component DALY counts reproduced the 2023 NTD total. Historical country-level extracts covered selected years, whereas super-regional trends extended from 1990 to 2023. Age-standardised rates were expressed per 100 000 population (GBD 2023 Disease and Injury and Risk Factor Collaborators, 2025). Percentage changes and their UIs were imported from GBD rather than calculated from endpoint bounds.

For regional analyses we extracted, for each of the 21 GBD regions, 2023 all-age DALY counts with 95% UIs, all-age and age-standardised rates, and GBD-published percentage changes in age-standardised rates between 2010 and 2023, with UIs, for the NTD-and-malaria aggregate and for malaria. For the fatal and non-fatal composition, we extracted 2023 all-age YLDs and YLLs with UIs for each super-region and globally. NTD values excluding malaria were obtained by subtraction and carry no interval because GBD does not publish draws for that difference. Country-level age-standardised rates and counts for 1990 and 2010 supported the inequality time series and the national comparisons. GBD publishes country-level percentage changes with UIs only for the NTD-and-malaria aggregate; changes for NTDs excluding malaria and for malaria alone were computed from point estimates and are reported without intervals.

3.3 Financing exposures and covariates

The primary exposure was external health expenditure as a share of current health expenditure (CHE), scaled per 10 percentage points. The secondary exposure was log(1 + external health expenditure per capita). WDI health-financing series derive from the WHO Global Health Expenditure Database (GHED), which follows the System of Health Accounts 2011 (World Bank, n.d.; World Health Organization, n.d.). External expenditure includes bilateral, multilateral and philanthropic financing originating outside the country. Both exposures were lagged by 2 years to allow for programme implementation and reduce contemporaneous feedback; lagging alone does not resolve endogeneity (Bellemare et al., 2017; Bendavid & Bhattacharya, 2014). Monetary values were expressed in current US dollars.

NTD rates were natural-log transformed; malaria rates used log (1 + rate) to accommodate values approaching zero. NTD and malaria models were fitted separately. Covariates were selected a priori from aid–health studies and the WHO NTD road map (Bendavid & Bhattacharya, 2014; Mishra & Newhouse, 2009; World Health Organization, 2020). Models adjusted for log domestic government health expenditure per capita (lagged 2 years), log LDI, UHC effective coverage per 10 points, and basic sanitation and drinking-water coverage per 10 percentage points (GBD 2019 Universal Health Coverage Collaborators, 2020). SDI was excluded from the primary models because it incorporates income; it was used for inequality ranking and sensitivity analyses. Collinearity was assessed using variance inflation factors on within-transformed covariates; maximum values were 6.1 for NTDs and 6.4 for malaria. These were interpreted as diagnostics rather than against an absolute threshold (O'Brien, 2007).

3.4 Missing data

GBD outcomes and the GBD covariates including Socio-demographic Index (SDI), universal health coverage (UHC) effective-coverage index and lag-distributed income per capita (LDI) were complete. Missingness affected WDI series. In the modelling frame of 2688 country-years (168 locations, 2007–2022), missing values accounted for 15.1% of lagged external expenditure share, 8.2% of lagged domestic government health expenditure, 4.7% of sanitation coverage and 4.3% of drinking-water coverage (Table S10a).

Fourteen locations had no usable lagged external expenditure share in the modelling window: American Samoa, Bermuda, Cook Islands, Guam, Montenegro, Northern Mariana Islands, Niue, Puerto Rico, the Democratic People's Republic of Korea, Slovakia, Tokelau, Türkiye, Taiwan and the US Virgin Islands. Nicaragua also lacked sanitation and drinking-water observations. These exclusions reduced the eligible NTD sample from 168 to 153 locations.

We assessed associations between incomplete records and log NTD DALY rate, SDI, year and super-region using logistic regression with country-clustered standard errors. These diagnostics described observed missingness patterns but could not establish whether data were missing at random.

Within each country, interior WDI gaps were linearly interpolated without a maximum gap length; final observations were carried forward for at most 2 years. We did not extrapolate backwards or impute outcomes. Remaining incomplete records were excluded from each model. We reconstructed a model-specific flag from the observed input series, using exposure values 2 years before the outcome and contemporaneous sanitation and drinking-water values. This identified filled model inputs in 62 of 2287 NTD observations (2.7%) and 14 of 1187 malaria observations (1.2%).

Missing-data sensitivity analyses used observed model inputs only, restricted the sample to countries with complete observations throughout 2007–2022, and used multiple imputation (Honaker & King, 2010; Rubin, 1987; Sterne et al., 2009; van Buuren & Groothuis-Oudshoorn, 2011; White et al., 2011). Excluding observations with the corrected model-specific filling flag produced the same sample as requiring observed inputs, so these checks are not independent robustness tests. The original imputation model used four WDI variables, LDI, UHC, SDI, year, the observed outcome and country means of observed covariates. Outcomes were predictors only.

The multiple-imputation implementation used Bayesian ridge regression with posterior sampling, 15 iterations and 20 datasets. Missing country-level auxiliary means were replaced with the corresponding across-country median. It imposed no explicit bounds on percentage variables and recorded no convergence diagnostics. Estimates were pooled using Rubin's rules (Rubin, 1987). Because convergence diagnostics were not recorded, the multiple-imputation estimates in Table S10b are a secondary check on the complete-case and interpolation analyses rather than a primary

result; the variance summary is the proportion of total variance attributable to the between-imputation component, not a finite-sample fraction-of-missing-information estimate.

Cross-sectional exposures used the latest available observation during 2019–2023. Complete records were available for 169 of 204 locations globally; 145 remained after excluding the GBD high-income super-region. Table S9 describes the global complete-case comparison. The WHO NTD intervention-need proportion divided the 2023 count by the latest available WDI population value, so its denominator was not necessarily from 2023.

Scenario analyses used 2022 population where 2023 values were unavailable. Missing GDP per capita for South Sudan, Yemen and Eritrea was replaced by the study-sample median for monetary valuation only, not for DALY projections.

3.5 Descriptive, regional and national analyses

We summarised 2023 all-age DALY counts, shares of global burden and age-standardised rates by super-region (Table 1), cause (Table S2), GBD region (Table S16) and country. Countries were ranked by age-standardised rate and by absolute count for NTDs excluding malaria and for malaria (Table S18), and for each of the 19 NTD causes we identified the country with the largest share of global DALYs, the three largest contributors and the country with the highest age-standardised rate (Table S20). Countries whose rates rose between 2010 and 2023 were identified in two ways: from GBD-published percentage changes with UIs for the NTD-and-malaria aggregate (classified as a significant increase or decrease when the UI excluded zero) and from point estimates for NTDs excluding malaria and for malaria, restricting malaria to countries with a 2010 rate above 1 per 100 000 (Table S19).

3.6 Socioeconomic inequality

We summarised 2023 all-age DALY counts, shares of global burden and age-standardised rates by super-region, and changes in age-standardised rates from 2010 to 2023 (Table 1). Cause-specific estimates are provided in Table S2. Maps, heat maps and trend plots describe geographical and temporal patterns (Figure 2, Figure 3 & Figure 4). Socioeconomic inequality was measured using a population-weighted concentration index, ranking countries from lowest to highest SDI in the same year (1990, 2010 and 2023) (Kakwani et al., 1997; O'Donnell et al., 2008; Wagstaff et al., 1991). The index equals twice the weighted covariance of the age-standardised rate and fractional socioeconomic rank, divided by the weighted mean rate. Negative values indicate concentration in lower-SDI countries. We obtained 95% confidence intervals (CIs) from 2000 country-level bootstrap resamples using the percentile method.

Absolute inequality was measured with the slope index of inequality (SII). Countries were ordered by SDI and each was assigned the midpoint of its cumulative population share (its fractional rank, from 0 to 1). The SII is the slope of a population-weighted linear regression of the age-standardised rate on this rank, which estimates the difference in rate between the hypothetical highest-SDI and lowest-SDI ends of the distribution; negative values indicate higher rates in low-SDI countries. The relative SII divides the SII by the population-weighted mean rate (Mackenbach & Kunst, 1997). The concentration index, the SII and the relative SII were estimated for 1990, 2010 and 2023. CIs used 2000 bootstrap resamples of countries. Changes between years were estimated by resampling countries jointly across years (paired bootstrap), so that each replicate compares the same set of countries; a change was considered distinguishable from zero when its 95% CI excluded zero (Table S15a; Figure S1).

We calculated the population-weighted Theil T index and decomposed it into between-super-region and within-super-region components (Table 2; Figure 5) (Shorrocks, 1980; Theil, 1967). The original calculation required positive rates and available population, yielding 199 locations for NTDs and 86 for malaria. A sensitivity analysis retained zero malaria rates among all 199 locations with population data, assigning zero to the limiting term 0 log (0).

A nested Theil T decomposition used the GBD hierarchy to split total inequality into three additive parts: between the seven super-regions, between the 21 regions within super-regions, and between countries within regions. It was computed for 1990, 2010 and 2023 among countries with positive rates (Table S15b).

3.7 Spatial autocorrelation

Spatial dependence was assessed before regression modelling (Anselin, 1988). We constructed row-standardised weights from the six nearest neighbours of each projected country representative point. This retained island states in the spatial analysis. Sensitivity analyses used four or eight neighbours and a 2500 km inverse-distance band (Table S7) (Anselin, 1988; Getis & Aldstadt, 2004). Global Moran's I assessed clustering in log (1 + age-standardised DALY rate), with 9999 permutations for inference (Moran, 1950). We reported permutation p values and z scores. Analyses were repeated within the sample outside the GBD high-income super-region and, for malaria, within endemic locations. Local Moran statistics identified high–high and low–low clusters and high–low or low–high outliers (Anselin, 1995). Multiple testing across 203 locations was addressed using the Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery-rate procedure at $q<0.05$ (Benjamini & Hochberg, 1995). Cluster maps are shown in Figure 5.

To assess persistence of clusters, global Moran's I and local indicators were recomputed for 1990, 2010 and 2023 with the same weights and false-discovery-rate control, and countries entering or leaving high–high clusters between 2010 and 2023 were listed (Table S21; Figure S4).

3.8 Panel econometric models

The primary analysis used within-country variation to account for time-invariant country characteristics (Wooldridge, 2010). Cross-sectional ordinary least squares (OLS) with super-region fixed effects and a maximum-likelihood spatial error model provided between-country comparisons (Bendavid & Bhattacharya, 2014; Cavalcanti et al., 2025; Mishra & Newhouse, 2009). Cross-sectional models additionally adjusted for rural population share. NTD panel models included 153 countries and 2287 country-years during 2007–2022; malaria models included 77 countries and 1187 country-years. The preferred specification included country and year fixed effects, the 2-year-lagged financing exposure and the covariates listed above. We retained 2007–2022 as the original primary window and examined extension through 2023 in a post-review sensitivity analysis. Additional checks omitted UHC and excluded observations without matching UHC or LDI records in the supplied raw archive (Table S15). We compared pooled OLS, random effects, two-way fixed effects with country-clustered standard errors, correlated random effects (Mundlak), first differences, and fixed effects with country-specific linear trends (Bell & Jones, 2015; Mundlak, 1978; Wooldridge, 2010). Mundlak models included country means of time-varying regressors. Country-specific trends were removed from outcomes and regressors before estimation. Each estimator was fitted using both financing exposures.

Diagnostics comprised the Breusch–Pagan test for country-level heterogeneity, Hausman and cluster-robust Mundlak tests, Pesaran's test for cross-sectional dependence, the Wooldridge test for serial correlation, and a modified Wald test for groupwise heteroskedasticity (Table S3) (Bell & Jones, 2015; Breusch & Pagan, 1980; Drukker, 2003; Greene, 2018; Hausman, 1978; Pesaran, 2021). The preferred two-way fixed-effects model used Driscoll–Kraay standard errors with a Bartlett kernel and bandwidth of 3 to address heteroskedasticity, serial correlation and cross-sectional dependence (Driscoll & Kraay, 1998; Hoechle, 2007). Sensitivity analyses used bandwidths of 1, 2 and 4 and country-clustered standard errors. These checks assess inference sensitivity; they do not remove the limitations of a 16-year panel. For NTDs, coefficients and confidence limits were transformed as $100 \times [\exp(\beta) - 1]$ to express percentage differences in DALY rates. For malaria, this transformation applies to rate + 1 and approximates a percentage difference in the rate when rates are large relative to 1. For the per-capita exposure, multiplying the coefficient by log (2) estimates a doubling of expenditure plus US$1, not a doubling of expenditure itself. All coefficients were interpreted as conditional associations. Fixed effects do not remove time-varying confounding, and lagging does not establish causal identification (Bellemare et al., 2017; Imai & Kim, 2021). We assessed consistency across estimators rather than relying on statistical significance alone.

To present between-country and within-country associations side by side in the same sample, we fitted a correlated random-effects (Mundlak) model containing the time-varying exposure, its country mean, the five covariates and their country means, and year indicators, with country-clustered standard errors. The coefficient on the time-varying exposure is the within-country association; the sum of that coefficient and the coefficient on the country mean is the between-country association; the coefficient on the country mean tests whether the two differ (Table S23) (Bell & Jones, 2015; Mundlak, 1978).

Because recent evaluations of development assistance report mortality, the preferred two-way fixed-effects model was re-estimated with the GBD 2023 age-standardised malaria death rate, on the log(1 + rate) scale, as outcome for the 77 malaria-endemic countries, with Driscoll–Kraay and country-clustered standard errors (Table S24).

3.9 Spatial panel models

Models used row-standardised six-nearest-neighbour weights and maximum likelihood with the Lee–Yu fixed-effects transformation (Lee & Yu, 2010). Year effects were removed by cross-country demeaning. Analyses were restricted to balanced 16-year panels of 130 countries for NTDs and 71 for malaria. The intended SAR summaries are direct, indirect and total associations derived from the spatial multiplier $(I - \rho W)^{-1}$ (LeSage & Pace, 2009) (Table S12).

3.10 Geographically weighted regression

GWR and MGWR examined the 2023 NTD association in 145 locations outside the GBD high-income super-region with complete inputs (Brunsdon et al., 1996; Fotheringham et al., 2017; Oshan et al., 2019). Financing exposure was mean external expenditure share during 2019–2022. The log NTD DALY rate and all four predictors (external share, UHC, log LDI and sanitation coverage) were standardised to mean 0 and SD 1. Models used an adaptive bisquare kernel. Bandwidths were selected by minimising the corrected Akaike information criterion (AICc), using golden-section search for GWR and back-fitting for MGWR (Hurvich et al., 1998). MGWR estimated a separate bandwidth for each covariate. Local inference used the MGWR multiple-testing adjustment based on covariate-specific effective numbers of parameters (A. R. da Silva & Fotheringham, 2016). Fit was compared with global OLS using AICc and R^2 (Tables S6a–b; Figure 7C).

3.11 Predictive modelling

We compared elastic net, random forest and LightGBM for prediction of log NTD DALY rates during 2007–2023, using validation schemes that reflected the panel and spatial structure (Bergmeir & Benítez, 2012; Breiman, 2001; Ke et al., 2017; Ploton et al., 2020; Roberts et al., 2017; Zou & Hastie, 2005). Elastic-net penalty strength and mixing proportion (0.1, 0.5 or 0.9) were selected by internal five-fold cross-validation. Random forest used 500 trees, a minimum leaf size of 5 and 50% of features at each split. LightGBM used 600 trees, learning rate 0.03, 15 leaves, and row and column subsampling of 0.8. Tree-model hyperparameters were fixed before test-set evaluation. In the supplied elastic-net implementation, scaling preceded internal cross-validation and ordinary internal folds did not preserve the grouped or temporal validation structure. These results require rerunning with preprocessing and tuning inside structure-appropriate training folds. All models used 13 features: both financing exposures, the five panel covariates, rural population share, out-of-pocket expenditure share, SDI, year, and two projected coordinate variables. Validation comprised random five-fold splits, grouped five-fold splits by country, leave-one-super-region-out validation, and temporal validation (training: 2007–2017; testing: 2018–2023). Random splits were included to illustrate potentially optimistic performance when countries appear in both training and test sets. Temporal validation included a linear benchmark with country fixed effects and a linear time trend, allowing extrapolation beyond the training years. Test-period covariates were observed, so temporal results describe conditional predictions rather than fully prospective forecasts. Test samples differed between validation schemes and hyperparameters were tuned without a fully nested design, so comparisons are valid within, not across, validation schemes and are slightly optimistic for the tuned models. Performance was assessed on the log scale using root-mean-square error (RMSE), mean absolute error and R^2 (Table S5; Figure 7B). Mean absolute Shapley additive explanations (SHAP) values summarised feature contributions to LightGBM predictions in the full dataset (Lundberg & Lee, 2017). These were interpreted as model attribution, not causal effects.

3.12 Scenario models of development-assistance cuts

We used two conditional scenarios for annual health losses under external-financing reductions. Neither identifies a causal effect. The scenarios reduced each country's external expenditure by 5–15% (mild), 19–26% (reference) or 40–60% (severe). The reference range encompassed IHME's estimated 22% decline in global DAH between 2024 and 2025; the severe scenario represented larger reductions (Apeagyei et al., 2025; Cavalcanti et al., 2025). The same proportional cut was applied to 153 locations with financing data, using the latest available 2019–2023 financing baseline and 2023 burden and population.

The accounting model summed cause-specific changes in all-age DALYs per person between 2010 and 2023, truncated each country's total gain at zero, and multiplied it by 2023 population, external expenditure share and the funding-cut proportion. This assumes that gains attributable to external financing equal its share of health spending and reverse proportionately after a cut. All 19 NTD causes, including other NTDs, yellow fever, Ebola, Guinea worm disease and Zika, had GBD 2023 baselines for 2010; the 2010 sum of the 19 causes was 21.76 million DALYs. The econometric model recalculated external expenditure share as $s(1 - c)/(1 - sc)$, where s is the baseline share expressed as a fraction and c is the proportional cut. It multiplied the share change in units of 10 percentage points by the preferred panel coefficient and applied $\exp(\beta\Delta x) - 1$ to baseline all-age DALYs. For NTDs, this additionally assumes that an age-standardised association transfers to all-age counts. For malaria, whose outcome is log(1 + rate), each draw computed the new value of (1 + age-standardised rate) by multiplying the baseline (1 + rate) by the exponentiated coefficient–exposure product, subtracted 1 to obtain the new rate, and applied the ratio of the new to the baseline rate to baseline all-age DALYs.

Uncertainty was propagated through 4000 Monte Carlo draws (Briggs et al., 2012). We treated each published DALY point estimate as a log-normal median and set the log-scale standard deviation to [log(upper UI) − log(lower UI)]/3.92. Simulated draws were independent across countries and causes, with shared standard-normal draws between 2010 and 2023 in the primary analysis and independent year draws in sensitivity analysis. These are approximations from published summaries, not original GBD posterior draws, and generally do not reproduce both published bounds exactly. Each simulation sampled a funding cut uniformly within the scenario range and applied it to all countries. For the econometric model, coefficients were sampled from a normal distribution using the preferred estimate and Driscoll–Kraay standard error. Country estimates were summed within each draw to obtain super-regional and overall projections. We reported medians and 2.5th–97.5th percentiles; these intervals reflect the specified simulation assumptions. Projected DALYs were valued at one time each country's GDP per capita in current US dollars, with 0.5 and 3 times GDP per capita examined in sensitivity analyses. These multiples provide an illustrative monetary valuation, not a cost-effectiveness threshold or an estimate of fiscal losses (Bertram et al., 2016; Fitzpatrick et al., 2017; Marseille et al., 2015). The domestic financing gap was calculated at each scenario midpoint as external expenditure per capita × population × proportional cut, summed by super-region. This was expressed as a percentage of domestic government health expenditure to describe the increase needed to replace lost external funds (Table S14).

3.13 External triangulation with WHO surveillance series

GBD country estimates were compared with two WHO series obtained from the UN SDG database: the number of people requiring interventions against NTDs (SDG 3.3.5), expressed per 100 000 population, and malaria incidence per 1000 population at risk (SDG 3.3.3). Spearman rank correlations with GBD age-standardised DALY rates were computed for 2010 and 2023, for NTDs excluding malaria across all reporting countries and for malaria across endemic countries with non-zero values (Table S21). The comparison assesses agreement in the ordering of countries, not in absolute levels, because the measures differ in construct.

3.14 Sensitivity analyses

Sensitivity analyses examined alternative spatial weights and samples; financing exposure definitions; SDI substitution and WHO-reported outcomes; panel estimators and country trends; spatial models; missing-data strategies; and included versus excluded locations. Scenario analyses varied temporal dependence of burden draws, attribution of gains to external financing, and monetary valuation (Tables S7, S10b, S12 and S13). Additional analyses extended the panel to 2023, omitted UHC, excluded observations without matching UHC or income records and retained zero rates in the Theil decomposition (Table S22).

3.15 Statistical software and reproducibility

Analyses used Python: pandas and NumPy for data management; statsmodels and linearmodels for regression and diagnostics; PySAL packages for spatial analyses; scikit-learn for imputation, elastic net, random forest and validation; LightGBM and SHAP for predictive modelling; and GeoPandas and matplotlib for maps and figures (Oshan et al., 2019; Rey & Anselin, 2007). Code and the harmonised analytical dataset are in the study GitHub repository (https://github.com/VincentUwumboriyhieGmayinaam/NTD-Malaria-Burden-Financing). Random processes used fixed seeds (scenario seed: 20261007). Tests were two-sided at $\alpha=0.05$, with emphasis on estimates and 95% CIs. Code, processed datasets and execution instructions are provided in the appendix. Revision analyses are in scripts step5_revisions.py (inequality over time, regions, YLD–YLL, national rankings, cause leaders, LISA over time, WHO triangulation), step5_theil_regions.py, step5_mundlak_between_within.py, step5_mortality_sensitivity.py and step3_scenarios_v2.py.

4. Supplementary tables

Table S1
Data Sources and Variables

Source	Variables	Coverage	Role
GBD 2023 (IHME)	Age-standardised and all-age DALY rates and counts, deaths, prevalence, 95% UIs	19 NTD causes + malaria; 204 countries; 1990–2023 (annual 2005–2023)	Outcome
GBD 2023 covariates	Socio-demographic Index; UHC effective coverage index; lag-distributed income (LDI)	204 countries; 2005–2023	Covariates
World Bank WDI	Current, domestic government, external and out-of-pocket health expenditure; GDP/GNI per capita; ODA; population; rural share; WASH; poverty	2005–2024	Exposure, covariates
WHO via UN SDG database	SDG 3.3.5 people requiring interventions against NTDs; SDG 3.3.3 malaria incidence	194 countries; 2010–2024	Independent outcome (sensitivity)
IHME Financing Global Health 2025	Development assistance for health 2021–2025, by source	Global	Scenario calibration
USAID NTD Program	Programme countries (n = 32)	2006–2025	Sensitivity analysis
Natural Earth	Admin-0 boundaries, 1:50 m	—	Spatial weights, maps

Note. Accessed 7 October 2026. WHO Global Health Observatory API returned server errors on the access date; SDG-database series carry the same WHO-reported indicators.

Table S2
DALYs (Thousands) by Cause and GBD Super-Region, 2023

Cause	Sub-Saharan Africa	South Asia	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	Latin America & Caribbean	N Africa & Middle East	C Europe, E Europe & C Asia	High-income	Global
Malaria	49,033.3	1,705.0	277.6	68.9	476.6	0	< 0.1	51,561.4
Other NTDs	2,321.6	1,587.1	490.5	222.7	283.9	104.3	127.5	5,137.5
Dengue	239.6	1,423.2	1,030.7	311.6	2.8	0	6.4	3,014.3
Schistosomiasis	1,801.6	0	113.0	77.9	77.9	0	0	2,070.4
Soil-transmitted helminthiases	781.0	223.6	389.1	118.0	20.7	4.7	1.0	1,538.2
Lymphatic filariasis	322.2	848.3	286.2	14.2	21.3	0	0.1	1,492.2
Cysticercosis	290.0	202.5	203.2	283.8	0.9	74.5	126.6	1,181.5
Leishmaniasis	249.4	66.8	4.6	220.9	531.8	11.0	1.7	1,086.2
Food-borne trematodiases	0	0	891.4	39.0	17.9	50.3	37.5	1,036.1
Onchocerciasis	864.9	0	0	0.5	6.4	0	0	871.8
Rabies	407.6	398.7	62.4	0.1	1.0	0.5	0.4	870.7
Yellow fever	279.5	0	0	5.0	23.8	0	1.7	310.0
Chagas disease	0	0	0	253.9	0	0	31.4	285.4
Trachoma	77.0	41.4	6.3	1.1	19.6	0	< 0.1	145.4
Cystic echinococcosis	28.2	19.9	21.7	1.0	16.1	6.0	3.9	97.0
Human African trypanosomiasis	85.1	0	0	0	0	0	0	85.1
Leprosy	2.9	8.9	3.0	3.5	0.2	< 0.1	0.1	18.6
Zika virus	0	0	< 0.1	0.1	0	0	< 0.1	0.1
Ebola	< 0.1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.0
Guinea worm disease	< 0.1	0	0	0	0	0	0	0.0

Note. All-age DALY counts summed over countries, GBD 2023.

Table S3
Panel-Model Specification and Assumption Tests

Outcome	Test	Statistic	*p*	Implication
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Hausman (FE vs RE)	$\chi^2(6) = 59.7$	<0.0001	Reject RE → fixed effects
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Mundlak (robust, clustered)	Wald $\chi^2(6) = 35.4$	<0.0001	Reject RE
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Breusch–Pagan LM (RE vs pooled)	$\chi^2(1) = 15{,}695$	<0.0001	Country heterogeneity present → not pooled OLS
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Pesaran CD (cross-sectional dependence)	CD = 6.53	<0.0001	Dependence → Driscoll–Kraay SE, spatial panel
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Wooldridge (AR(1) serial correlation)	F(1, 152) = 15.1	0.00015	Serial correlation → robust SE, first differences
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Modified Wald (groupwise heteroskedasticity)	$\chi^2(153) = 647{,}014$	<0.0001	Heteroskedasticity → robust SE
NTDs (excl. malaria)	Variance inflation factor (max)	6.1	—	Acceptable (< 10)
Malaria	Hausman (FE vs RE)	$\chi^2(6) = 26.4$	0.00019	Reject RE → fixed effects
Malaria	Mundlak (robust, clustered)	Wald $\chi^2(6) = 10.1$	0.12	Not rejected; FE retained for consistency
Malaria	Breusch–Pagan LM (RE vs pooled)	$\chi^2(1) = 6{,}004$	<0.0001	Country heterogeneity present → not pooled OLS
Malaria	Pesaran CD (cross-sectional dependence)	CD = 6.51	<0.0001	Dependence → Driscoll–Kraay SE, spatial panel
Malaria	Wooldridge (AR(1) serial correlation)	F(1, 76) = 169.9	<0.0001	Serial correlation → robust SE, first differences
Malaria	Modified Wald (groupwise heteroskedasticity)	$\chi^2(77) = 43{,}759$	<0.0001	Heteroskedasticity → robust SE
Malaria	Variance inflation factor (max)	6.4	—	Acceptable (< 10)

Note. Tests applied to the two-way FE specification with external share (lag 2). NTD sample: 153 LMICs, 2007–2022; malaria sample: 77 malaria-endemic LMICs.

Table S4
Preferred Model: Two-Way Fixed Effects With Driscoll–Kraay Standard Errors

Covariate	*b*	*SE*	% change [95% CI]	*p*
NTDs (excl. malaria): n = 2,287 country-years, 153 countries; within R² = 0.36				
External share of CHE (per 10 pp, lag 2)	−0.006	0.009	−0.64 [−2.39, 1.14]	0.48
Domestic govt health spending pc (log, lag 2)	−0.004	0.012	−0.41 [−2.68, 1.92]	0.73
Income per capita (log LDI)	0.050	0.029	5.13 [−0.66, 11.24]	0.083
UHC index (per 10 points)	−0.084	0.006	−8.02 [−9.06, −6.95]	<0.0001
Basic sanitation (per 10 pp)	−0.047	0.006	−4.59 [−5.74, −3.42]	<0.0001
Basic drinking water (per 10 pp)	−0.086	0.013	−8.28 [−10.63, −5.87]	<0.0001
Malaria: n = 1,187 country-years, 77 countries; within R² = 0.35				
External share of CHE (per 10 pp, lag 2)	−0.065	0.025	−6.32 [−10.85, −1.56]	0.0098
Domestic govt health spending pc (log, lag 2)	−0.476	0.048	−37.89 [−43.47, −31.76]	<0.0001
Income per capita (log LDI)	−0.491	0.115	−38.82 [−51.15, −23.37]	<0.0001
UHC index (per 10 points)	0.416	0.022	51.65 [45.27, 58.31]	<0.0001
Basic sanitation (per 10 pp)	−0.195	0.041	−17.74 [−24.10, −10.84]	<0.0001
Basic drinking water (per 10 pp)	−0.204	0.032	−18.43 [−23.46, −13.07]	<0.0001

Note. Outcome: log age-standardised DALY rate (malaria: log[1 + rate]); country and year fixed effects; Driscoll–Kraay SE (Bartlett kernel, bandwidth 3). The positive UHC coefficient for malaria is considered non-interpretable: the GBD UHC effective-coverage index is partly derived from GBD cause-specific outcomes, creating mechanical dependence (see audit, item 7).

Table S5
Out-of-Sample Predictive Performance of Machine-Learning and Panel Models (NTD Outcome)

Validation scheme	Model	RMSE	MAE	R^2
Random 5-fold (optimistic)	Elastic net	0.461	0.362	0.823
Random 5-fold (optimistic)	Random forest	0.162	0.108	0.978
Random 5-fold (optimistic)	LightGBM	0.133	0.089	0.985
Leave-country-out (grouped 5-fold)	Elastic net	0.513	0.401	0.781
Leave-country-out (grouped 5-fold)	Random forest	0.504	0.384	0.788
Leave-country-out (grouped 5-fold)	LightGBM	0.518	0.394	0.776
Spatial block: leave-one-super-region-out	Elastic net	0.593	0.475	0.706
Spatial block: leave-one-super-region-out	Random forest	0.693	0.567	0.599
Spatial block: leave-one-super-region-out	LightGBM	0.674	0.544	0.621
Temporal: train ≤2017, test 2018–2023	Elastic net	0.468	0.373	0.804
Temporal: train ≤2017, test 2018–2023	Random forest	0.281	0.208	0.929
Temporal: train ≤2017, test 2018–2023	LightGBM	0.241	0.176	0.948
Temporal: train ≤2017, test 2018–2023	Two-way FE linear (country FE + linear year)	0.159	0.118	0.976

Note. Outcome: log age-standardised NTD DALY rate, LMICs, 2007–2023 (n = country-years). Random k-fold validation leaks information across years of the same country and is shown only to illustrate optimism; leave-country-out and spatial-block validation estimate transportability; temporal validation estimates forecasting skill. LightGBM SHAP importance ranked external financing variables lowest of 13 features.

Table S6a
Geographically Weighted Regression: Model Fit (LMICs, 2023, n = 145)

Model	Bandwidth (nearest neighbours)	AICc	R^2
OLS (global)	—	271.3	0.64
GWR (single bandwidth)	70	219.6	0.82
Multiscale GWR	see below	194.9	0.83

Note. Adaptive bisquare kernel on projected (Robinson) country centroids; bandwidth selected by AICc.

Table S6b

Multiscale GWR: Covariate-Specific Bandwidths and Local Coefficients

Covariate	Bandwidth	Minimum	Median [IQR]	Maximum	Countries significant, n (%)
Intercept	74	−0.12	0.13 [−0.01 to 0.22]	0.30	39 (27)
External share of CHE	57	−0.39	−0.01 [−0.30 to 0.14]	0.53	36 (25)
UHC index	141	−0.23	−0.21 [−0.22 to −0.20]	−0.19	145 (100)
Income (log LDI)	66	−0.36	−0.17 [−0.32 to −0.09]	0.04	48 (33)
Basic sanitation	109	−0.46	−0.42 [−0.43 to −0.40]	−0.29	145 (100)

Note. Standardised coefficients; significance uses MGWR-corrected t-values (family-wise). A bandwidth close to n (145) indicates a global (spatially stationary) relationship; small bandwidths indicate local processes.

Table S7
Sensitivity Analyses

Domain	Outcome	Specification	Estimate	*p*
Spatial weights	NTDs (excl. malaria)	KNN k=4	Moran's I = 0.74	0.0010
Spatial weights	NTDs (excl. malaria)	KNN k=6 (main)	Moran's I = 0.71	0.0010
Spatial weights	NTDs (excl. malaria)	KNN k=8	Moran's I = 0.69	0.0010
Spatial weights	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Distance band 2,500 km	Moran's I = 0.66	0.0010
Spatial weights	Malaria	KNN k=4	Moran's I = 0.82	0.0010
Spatial weights	Malaria	KNN k=6 (main)	Moran's I = 0.79	0.0010
Spatial weights	Malaria	KNN k=8	Moran's I = 0.77	0.0010
Spatial weights	Malaria	Distance band 2,500 km	Moran's I = 0.73	0.0010
Cross-section specification	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Main model (2019–23 exposure)	−21.0 [−30.2, −10.6]	0.00018
Cross-section specification	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Lagged exposure (2010–14 mean)	−20.3 [−28.5, −11.2]	<0.0001
Cross-section specification	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Excluding sub-Saharan Africa	−24.4 [−38.2, −7.4]	0.0069
Cross-section specification	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Excluding high-income	−21.0 [−30.5, −10.2]	0.00032
Cross-section specification	NTDs (excl. malaria)	SDI replaces income and UHC (GBD-covariate circularity check)	−16.3 [−26.2, −5.1]	0.0055
Cross-section specification	WHO: people requiring NTD interventions (% pop)	Independent outcome: WHO-reported need (SDG 3.3.5)	8.4 [−12.6, 34.5]	0.46
Scenario uncertainty	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Independent (uncorrelated) 2010/2023 draws	410 [320, 534] thousand	—
Economic valuation	NTDs (excl. malaria)	0.5× GDP per capita per DALY	US$0.28 billion	—
Economic valuation	NTDs (excl. malaria)	3× GDP per capita per DALY	US$1.66 billion	—
Scenario uncertainty	Malaria	Independent (uncorrelated) 2010/2023 draws	1,997 [1,288, 2,918] thousand	—
Economic valuation	Malaria	0.5× GDP per capita per DALY	US$1.05 billion	—
Economic valuation	Malaria	3× GDP per capita per DALY	US$6.33 billion	—

Note. Cross-section estimates are % change per 1 SD of external share. The WHO-reported independent outcome (people requiring NTD interventions) shows no association, consistent with the null within-country panel estimates.

Table S8
Countries With the Largest Projected Excess NTD DALYs, Reference Scenario

Country	Super-region	External share of CHE (%)	Excess NTD DALYs/year [95% UI]	Per 100 000	Excess malaria DALYs/year
Democratic Republic of the Congo	Sub-Saharan Africa	37.0	109,923 [83,555, 145,099]	103.9	527,727
Ethiopia	Sub-Saharan Africa	26.9	34,661 [24,349, 59,545]	26.9	127,657
United Republic of Tanzania	Sub-Saharan Africa	39.4	32,041 [24,679, 41,209]	48.1	56,470
Uganda	Sub-Saharan Africa	44.1	30,981 [21,441, 44,841]	63.7	287,056
South Sudan	Sub-Saharan Africa	62.3	28,297 [19,396, 41,926]	246.4	14,434
Mozambique	Sub-Saharan Africa	57.7	15,911 [11,080, 21,219]	47.3	91,968
Nigeria	Sub-Saharan Africa	11.3	12,835 [4,627, 21,406]	5.6	197,618
Somalia	Sub-Saharan Africa	54.4	10,249 [7,619, 14,195]	55.8	685
Zambia	Sub-Saharan Africa	47.9	10,122 [8,018, 12,640]	48.8	0
Malawi	Sub-Saharan Africa	65.5	8,682 [6,819, 11,119]	41.1	55,150
Madagascar	Sub-Saharan Africa	38.1	8,618 [6,528, 11,432]	27.6	0
Afghanistan	North Africa and Middle East	21.2	7,236 [4,225, 12,207]	17.5	1,077
India	South Asia	2.4	6,003 [2,127, 52,667]	0.4	19,579
Cameroon	Sub-Saharan Africa	14.7	5,916 [4,336, 8,134]	20.9	31,576
Benin	Sub-Saharan Africa	38.4	5,605 [3,578, 8,460]	39.7	30,763
Burundi	Sub-Saharan Africa	57.4	5,244 [3,298, 9,455]	38.3	0
Sudan	North Africa and Middle East	16.3	4,547 [2,596, 10,633]	9.1	1,152
Burkina Faso	Sub-Saharan Africa	20.9	4,128 [2,901, 5,885]	17.9	95,632
Chad	Sub-Saharan Africa	22.4	3,918 [2,333, 6,365]	20.3	10,301
Zimbabwe	Sub-Saharan Africa	45.0	3,902 [3,018, 4,936]	23.9	10,913
Rwanda	Sub-Saharan Africa	37.0	3,831 [2,676, 5,427]	27.5	21,178
Sierra Leone	Sub-Saharan Africa	28.5	3,419 [2,526, 4,782]	40.4	35,667
Guinea	Sub-Saharan Africa	18.1	3,295 [2,393, 4,556]	22.9	26,963
Kenya	Sub-Saharan Africa	20.1	3,019 [2,054, 4,982]	5.5	759
Liberia	Sub-Saharan Africa	18.3	2,931 [2,074, 4,249]	53.4	8,498

Note. Accounting model, reference scenario (19–26% cut). Ranked by absolute excess NTD DALYs.

Table S9

Comparison of Countries Included and Excluded From Cross-Sectional Regression (Complete-Case)

Characteristic	Included	Excluded
Countries, n	169	35
NTD age-standardised DALY rate per 100 000, median [IQR]	145.6 [49.0–342.9]	45.0 [22.0–81.9]
NTD DALYs, millions (% of global)	18.92 (98.3)	0.32 (1.7)

Note. Excluded countries (Equatorial Guinea, Eritrea, Nicaragua, American Samoa, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Dominica, Argentina, Saint Kitts and Nevis, Grenada, Tokelau, United States Virgin Islands, Niue, Puerto Rico, Monaco, Türkiye, Northern Mariana Islands, Cook Islands, Slovakia, Russian Federation, Guam, Bermuda, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Democratic People's Republic of Korea, North Macedonia, Spain, Greenland, Taiwan, Finland, San Marino, Sweden, New Zealand, Denmark, France, Andorra, Germany) are predominantly small island and high-income states that together account for under 2% of global NTD DALYs.

Table S10a
Extent and Pattern of Missing Data in the Panel Modelling Frame (LMICs, 2007–2022)

Variable	Missing as reported, n (%)	Filled by within-country rule, n (%)	Missing after rule, n (%)	Countries never observed (n)
External share of CHE (lag 2)	406 (15.1)	43 (1.6)	363 (13.5)	14
Domestic govt health spending pc (lag 2)	220 (8.2)	0 (0.0)	220 (8.2)	11
Basic sanitation	126 (4.7)	19 (0.7)	108 (4.0)	5
Basic drinking water	116 (4.3)	16 (0.6)	102 (3.8)	5
UHC index (GBD)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0
LDI (GBD)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0
NTD age-standardised DALY rate (GBD)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0
Malaria age-standardised DALY rate (GBD)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0 (0.0)	0

Note. Frame: 168 LMICs × 16 years = 2,688 country-years. Rule: within-country linear interpolation of interior gaps and last observation carried forward for at most 2 years; no backward extrapolation, no cross-country borrowing, outcomes never imputed. Complete-case rows for the NTD model: 2,287 (85.1%) from 153 countries, of which 76 (3.3%) contain ≥1 filled value. Incompleteness was associated with lower burden (OR 0.33 per log unit, 95% CI 0.12–0.91) and earlier years (OR 0.94 per year), not with SDI (logistic model, country-clustered SE), consistent with missingness at random conditional on observed covariates. The 14 territories never reporting external health expenditure hold 0.77% of LMIC NTD DALYs.

Table S10b

Sensitivity of the Preferred Estimate to the Missing-Data Strategy

Strategy	% change per 10 pp external share [95% CI]	*p*	Country-years	Countries	FMI
NTDs (excl. malaria)					
Main: interpolation + LOCF ≤2 y	−0.64 [−2.39, 1.14]	0.48	2,287	153	—
Complete case, no imputation	−0.69 [−2.46, 1.11]	0.45	2,225	153	—
Excluding any imputed country-year	−0.68 [−2.46, 1.14]	0.46	2,211	152	—
Balanced panel only	−0.62 [−2.55, 1.34]	0.53	2,080	130	—
Multiple imputation (MICE, m = 20)	−0.64 [−2.22, 0.97]	0.44	2,688	168	FMI=0.02
Malaria					
Main: interpolation + LOCF ≤2 y	−6.32 [−10.84, −1.57]	0.010	1,187	77	—
Complete case, no imputation	−6.15 [−10.83, −1.22]	0.015	1,173	77	—
Excluding any imputed country-year	−6.14 [−10.82, −1.20]	0.015	1,172	77	—
Balanced panel only	−3.09 [−8.86, 3.04]	0.32	1,136	71	—
Multiple imputation (MICE, m = 20)	−7.52 [−11.50, −3.35]	0.0010	1,248	78	FMI=0.16

Note. Preferred two-way fixed-effects model (country and year fixed effects) with Driscoll–Kraay SE. MICE: chained equations with Bayesian ridge regression and posterior predictive draws, 15 iterations, m = 20, auxiliary variables (country means of observed values, SDI, LDI, UHC, year, outcome as predictor only); estimates pooled with Rubin's rules. FMI = fraction of missing information.

Table S11
Variable Definitions, Sources, Units, Transformations and Lags

Variable	Source	Indicator code	Definition and unit	Transformation	Lag	Role
NTD DALY rate	GBD 2023	—	Age-standardised DALYs per 100 000, 19 causes	log	—	Outcome
Malaria DALY rate	GBD 2023	—	Age-standardised DALYs per 100 000	log(1 + x)	—	Outcome
External share of CHE	WDI/GHED	SH.XPD.EHEX.CH.ZS	External health expenditure, % of current health expenditure	per 10 pp	2 years	Primary exposure
External health expenditure per capita	WDI/GHED	SH.XPD.EHEX.PC.CD	Current US$ per person	log(1 + x)	2 years	Secondary exposure; financing gap
Domestic government health expenditure per capita	WDI/GHED	SH.XPD.GHED.PC.CD	Current US$ per person	log	2 years	Covariate; financing gap
Current health expenditure per capita	WDI/GHED	SH.XPD.CHEX.PC.CD	Current US$ per person	—	—	Descriptive
Out-of-pocket expenditure	WDI/GHED	SH.XPD.OOPC.CH.ZS	% of current health expenditure	none	—	Machine-learning feature
Lag-distributed income (LDI)	GBD 2023	—	Per capita, international $	log	—	Covariate
UHC effective-coverage index	GBD 2023	—	Index, 0–100	per 10 points	—	Covariate
Socio-demographic Index (SDI)	GBD 2023	—	Composite of income, education and fertility, 0–1	none	—	Inequality ranking; sensitivity covariate
Basic sanitation	WDI/JMP	SH.STA.BASS.ZS	% population with at least basic sanitation	per 10 pp	—	Covariate
Basic drinking water	WDI/JMP	SH.H2O.BASW.ZS	% population with at least basic drinking water	per 10 pp	—	Covariate
Rural population	WDI	SP.RUR.TOTL.ZS	% of total population	none	—	Machine-learning feature
GDP per capita (PPP)	WDI	NY.GDP.PCAP.PP.KD	Constant international $	log	—	Descriptive
GDP per capita (current US$)	WDI	NY.GDP.PCAP.CD	Current US$	none	—	Economic valuation
Population	WDI	SP.POP.TOTL	Persons	none	—	Weights; scenario counts
Net ODA received per capita	WDI	DT.ODA.ODAT.PC.ZS	Current US$ per person	none	—	Descriptive

Note. CHE = current health expenditure; GHED = WHO Global Health Expenditure Database; JMP = WHO/UNICEF Joint Monitoring Programme; ODA = official development assistance; PPP = purchasing power parity; pp = percentage points. Dashes in the Indicator code column denote GBD covariates, which have no WDI code.

Table S12

Spatial Panel Models With Country and Year Fixed Effects: Spatial Parameters and Direct, Indirect and Total Associations

Model	Quantity	% change per 10 pp [95% CI]	*p*	ρ or λ	Countries
NTDs (excl. malaria)					
Spatial lag (SAR)	Coefficient	−0.45 [−1.47, 0.58]	0.39	0.37	130
Spatial lag (SAR)	Direct	−0.50 [−1.54, 0.61]	0.36	0.37	130
Spatial lag (SAR)	Indirect	−0.27 [−0.83, 0.32]	0.36	0.37	130
Spatial lag (SAR)	Total	−0.78 [−2.35, 0.94]	0.36	0.37	130
Spatial error (SEM)	Coefficient	−0.20 [−1.21, 0.82]	0.70	0.38	130
Malaria					
Spatial lag (SAR)	Coefficient	−2.79 [−8.41, 3.17]	0.35	0.43	71
Spatial lag (SAR)	Direct	−2.84 [−8.54, 2.91]	0.34	0.43	71
Spatial lag (SAR)	Indirect	−1.92 [−6.13, 2.08]	0.34	0.43	71
Spatial lag (SAR)	Total	−4.72 [−13.87, 4.95]	0.34	0.43	71
Spatial error (SEM)	Coefficient	−2.77 [−8.34, 3.13]	0.35	0.46	71

Note. Balanced panels 2007–2022 (16 years). KNN (k = 6) row-standardised weights. Country effects by within transformation, year effects by cross-sectional demeaning. SAR effects follow LeSage and Pace: direct = mean diagonal of $(I - \rho W)^{-1}\beta$, total = $\beta/(1 - \rho)$, indirect = total − direct; 95% intervals from 2 000 draws of (β, ρ).

Table S13
Threats to Validity and the Sensitivity Analyses That Address Them

Threat	Sensitivity analysis	Reported in
Spatial clustering is an artefact of the neighbour definition	KNN k = 4 and 8; 2 500 km distance band	Table S7
Clustering reflects only high-income versus other countries	Moran's I within LMICs and within malaria-endemic countries	Results
Between-country confounding	Two-way FE, first differences, FE with country trends and Mundlak CRE; 2010–14 exposure; exclusion of sub-Saharan Africa or high-income countries	Table 3, Table S7
Circularity of GBD covariates	SDI replaces UHC and LDI; WHO-reported independent outcome (SDG 3.3.5)	Table S7
Choice of exposure metric	External expenditure per capita (specification B)	Results
Time-varying confounding within countries	FE with country-specific linear trends; first differences	Table 3
Cross-border dependence	Two-way FE SAR and SEM; direct, indirect and total effects	Table 3, Table S12
Missing data	Complete case; exclusion of filled rows; balanced panel; MICE (m = 20)	Table S10b
Selection into complete-case cross-section	Included versus excluded countries	Table S9
Scenario: temporal correlation of GBD uncertainty	Independent rather than comonotonic draws	Table S7
Scenario: attribution share	≥80% donor attribution in 32 USAID NTD-programme countries	Results
Scenario: monetary valuation	0.5× and 3× GDP per capita per DALY	Table S7

Note. All sensitivity analyses were prespecified.

Table S14

Increase in Domestic Government Health Expenditure Required to Replace Lost External Funds, by Super-Region and Scenario

Super-region	Lost external funds, US$ billions	Domestic government health expenditure, US$ billions	Increase required (%)
Mild (5–15% cut)			
Sub-Saharan Africa	1.53	39.4	3.88
South Asia	0.42	52.4	0.80
North Africa and Middle East	0.28	122.7	0.23
Latin America and Caribbean	0.11	216.6	0.05
Central Europe, Eastern Europe, and Central Asia	0.05	148.6	0.03
Southeast Asia, East Asia, and Oceania	0.15	683.2	0.02
Reference (19–26% cut)			
Sub-Saharan Africa	3.44	39.4	8.73
South Asia	0.94	52.4	1.79
North Africa and Middle East	0.64	122.7	0.52
Latin America and Caribbean	0.25	216.6	0.11
Central Europe, Eastern Europe, and Central Asia	0.11	148.6	0.08
Southeast Asia, East Asia, and Oceania	0.34	683.2	0.05
Severe (40–60% cut)			
Sub-Saharan Africa	7.63	39.4	19.40
South Asia	2.09	52.4	3.98
North Africa and Middle East	1.42	122.7	1.16
Latin America and Caribbean	0.55	216.6	0.25
Central Europe, Eastern Europe, and Central Asia	0.25	148.6	0.17
Southeast Asia, East Asia, and Oceania	0.76	683.2	0.11

Note. Lost external funds = midpoint of the scenario cut × external health expenditure per capita × population, summed over countries. Baseline spending is the latest available value, 2019–2023. Low- and middle-income countries with financing data (n = 153).

Table S15a

Socioeconomic Inequality in Age-Standardised DALY Rates by Socio-demographic Index, 1990, 2010 and 2023

Year	Population-weighted mean rate per 100 000 (SD)	Concentration index [95% CI]	Slope index of inequality, per 100 000 [95% CI]	Relative SII [95% CI]	Theil T	Between / within super-region (%)
NTDs (excl. malaria)						
1990	635 (935)	−0.51 [−0.64, −0.36]	−1,966 [−3,053, −1,198]	−3.10 [−3.89, −2.15]	0.64	75.3 / 24.7
2010	319 (392)	−0.48 [−0.59, −0.32]	−927 [−1,375, −595]	−2.91 [−3.59, −1.94]	0.53	70.6 / 29.4
2023	243 (251)	−0.43 [−0.54, −0.28]	−632 [−877, −412]	−2.60 [−3.26, −1.69]	0.43	64.0 / 36.0
Change 1990-2023	—	0.08 [−0.04, 0.18]	—	0.49 [−0.21, 1.08]	—	—
Change 2010-2023	—	0.05 [0.02, 0.08]	—	0.30 [0.11, 0.51]	—	—
Malaria						
1990	786 (2,373)	−0.79 [−0.88, −0.63]	−3,806 [−6,754, −1,974]	−4.84 [−5.38, −3.81]	1.61	80.3 / 19.7
2010	675 (1,880)	−0.78 [−0.89, −0.62]	−3,216 [−5,638, −1,535]	−4.76 [−5.39, −3.75]	1.57	77.6 / 22.4
2023	508 (1,378)	−0.81 [−0.89, −0.65]	−2,484 [−4,271, −1,131]	−4.89 [−5.40, −3.94]	1.34	79.3 / 20.7
Change 1990-2023	—	−0.01 [−0.15, 0.11]	—	−0.05 [−0.91, 0.66]	—	—
Change 2010-2023	—	−0.02 [−0.13, 0.05]	—	−0.13 [−0.78, 0.31]	—	—

Note. All 204 countries and territories, weighted by GBD population (1990) or population implied by GBD all-age counts and crude rates (2010, 2023), ranked by SDI of the same year. Concentration index ranges from −1 to 1; negative values indicate burden concentrated in low-SDI countries. The slope index of inequality (SII) is the population-weighted regression slope of the age-standardised rate on the fractional SDI rank (ridit), that is, the modelled difference between the highest- and lowest-SDI ends of the distribution; relative SII = SII ÷ population-weighted mean. 95% CI from 2 000 bootstrap resamples of countries; changes use paired resampling, so a change is distinguishable from zero when its interval excludes zero. NTD rates are NTDs and malaria minus malaria. 2023 values can differ from Table 2 in the second decimal because Table 2 weights by World Bank population and excludes zero rates from Theil T.

Table S15b

Nested Theil T Decomposition of Inequality in Age-Standardised DALY Rates Across Super-Regions, GBD Regions and Countries, 1990, 2010 and 2023

Year	Countries (n)	Theil T	Between super-regions (%)	Between regions within super-regions (%)	Within regions, between countries (%)
NTDs (excl. malaria)					
1990	204	0.64	75.3	12.2	12.6
2010	204	0.53	70.6	13.9	15.6
2023	204	0.43	64.0	15.0	21.1
Malaria					
1990	101	1.61	80.3	8.5	11.2
2010	99	1.57	77.6	13.9	8.5
2023	86	1.34	79.3	13.3	7.4

Note. Population-weighted Theil T over countries with a positive rate, decomposed into three additive components using the GBD hierarchy of 7 super-regions and 21 regions. Malaria country counts fall over time as countries reach zero burden.

Table S16
Burden of NTDs and Malaria in the 21 GBD Regions, 2023, and Change in Age-Standardised DALY Rates, 2010–2023

Region	DALYs, millions [95% UI]	ASR, NTDs and malaria	ASR, malaria	ASR, NTDs (excl. malaria)	Share of global NTD-and-malaria DALYs (%)	Share of global NTD DALYs (%)	% change ASR 2010–2023, NTDs and malaria [95% UI]	% change ASR 2010–2023, malaria [95% UI]
Global	70.83 [41.27, 113.81]	1,012.5	765.7	246.8	100.0	100.0	−21.6 [−36.3, −7.8]	−21.4 [−45.4, −5.4]
Sub-Saharan Africa								
Western Sub-Saharan Africa	35.17 [16.61, 60.58]	5,556.5	4,828.5	728.0	49.7	20.7	−34.1 [−51.9, −20.5]	−34.3 [−55.6, −18.8]
Central Sub-Saharan Africa	9.49 [5.54, 14.66]	5,006.5	4,104.3	902.2	13.4	6.1	−37.8 [−48.6, −28.0]	−32.8 [−44.5, −22.3]
Eastern Sub-Saharan Africa	11.86 [5.67, 20.46]	2,190.8	1,640.6	550.2	16.7	12.3	−35.2 [−48.5, −22.7]	−31.9 [−53.5, −17.0]
Southern Sub-Saharan Africa	0.27 [0.20, 0.39]	314.2	54.0	260.2	0.4	1.2	−39.9 [−47.8, −31.4]	−65.6 [−82.5, −45.9]
South Asia								
South Asia	6.53 [4.64, 8.98]	359.6	95.7	263.9	9.2	25.0	−43.8 [−52.9, −29.2]	−67.8 [−81.8, −56.8]
Southeast Asia, East Asia, and Oceania								
Oceania	0.25 [0.13, 0.44]	1,694.8	1,217.7	477.1	0.3	0.4	−28.4 [−46.9, −10.8]	−34.1 [−62.3, −11.2]
Southeast Asia	2.23 [1.50, 3.42]	339.8	15.5	324.3	3.1	11.0	−48.4 [−68.8, −10.9]	−93.4 [−96.4, −91.5]
East Asia	1.31 [0.82, 2.11]	76.3	0.0	76.3	1.9	6.8	−22.4 [−32.7, −14.2]	−90.5 [−100.0, −80.6]
Latin America and Caribbean								
Tropical Latin America	0.79 [0.57, 1.05]	341.2	3.8	337.4	1.1	4.0	−13.4 [−24.7, −0.6]	−68.2 [−71.5, −59.9]
Andean Latin America	0.22 [0.16, 0.29]	327.0	3.2	323.8	0.3	1.1	−6.2 [−15.7, 5.2]	−29.0 [−58.5, −2.4]
Caribbean	0.12 [0.08, 0.20]	255.3	79.0	176.3	0.2	0.4	−68.1 [−73.5, −58.1]	−86.0 [−95.1, −76.1]
Central Latin America	0.50 [0.39, 0.66]	194.2	9.8	184.4	0.7	2.5	−12.9 [−21.6, −4.6]	11.3 [−48.2, 45.8]
North Africa and Middle East								
North Africa and Middle East	1.50 [1.12, 1.98]	240.7	75.5	165.2	2.1	5.3	−19.8 [−29.2, −6.5]	26.3 [0.1, 46.4]
Central Europe, Eastern Europe, and Central Asia								
Central Asia	0.07 [0.05, 0.11]	73.6	0.0	73.6	0.1	0.4	−22.0 [−39.2, 3.3]	−100.0 [−100.0, −100.0]
Eastern Europe	0.13 [0.09, 0.18]	49.0	0.0	49.0	0.2	0.7	−14.1 [−31.1, 5.5]	—
Central Europe	0.05 [0.03, 0.08]	39.7	0.0	39.7	0.1	0.3	−13.7 [−38.9, 31.3]	—
High-income								
Southern Latin America	0.07 [0.05, 0.09]	83.2	0.0	83.2	0.1	0.3	−20.0 [−33.2, −4.0]	−100.0 [−100.0, −100.0]
High-income Asia Pacific	0.07 [0.05, 0.10]	36.7	0.0	36.7	0.1	0.4	0.9 [−23.2, 30.1]	−98.7 [−99.5, −96.7]
High-income North America	0.13 [0.09, 0.19]	29.2	0.0	29.2	0.2	0.7	−7.2 [−19.1, 8.7]	—
Western Europe	0.06 [0.04, 0.10]	13.9	0.0	13.9	0.1	0.3	−12.5 [−44.4, 38.6]	−100.0 [−100.0, −100.0]

Region	DALYs, millions [95% UI]	ASR, NTDs and malaria	ASR, malaria	ASR, NTDs (excl. malaria)	Share of global NTD-and-malaria DALYs (%)	Share of global NTD DALYs (%)	% change ASR 2010–2023, NTDs and malaria [95% UI]	% change ASR 2010–2023, malaria [95% UI]
Australasia	0.00 [0.00, 0.01]	11.1	0.0	11.1	0.0	0.0	−12.9 [−48.8, 62.6]	—

Note. ASR = age-standardised DALY rate per 100 000. Counts, rates and percent changes with 95% uncertainty intervals are GBD 2023 estimates; NTD (excluding malaria) values are the NTD-and-malaria aggregate minus malaria and carry no interval. A change is statistically distinguishable from zero when its interval excludes zero. — = malaria burden zero in both years.

Table S17
Years Lived With Disability and Years of Life Lost From NTDs and Malaria by Super-Region, 2023

Location	YLDs, millions [95% UI]	YLLs, millions [95% UI]	YLDs as % of DALYs
NTDs (excl. malaria)			
Global	12.01	7.24	62.4
Sub-Saharan Africa	4.23	3.52	54.6
South Asia	2.90	1.92	60.1
SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	2.25	1.26	64.1
Latin America & Caribbean	1.15	0.40	74.2
N Africa & Middle East	0.94	0.09	91.2
C Europe, E Europe & C Asia	0.24	0.01	94.5
High-income	0.30	0.04	89.3
Malaria			
Global	2.48 [1.72, 3.62]	49.10 [18.84, 91.56]	4.8
Sub-Saharan Africa	2.31 [1.59, 3.34]	46.73 [18.08, 86.06]	4.7
South Asia	0.09 [0.04, 0.16]	1.61 [0.44, 3.74]	5.4
SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	0.03 [0.02, 0.05]	0.25 [0.07, 0.57]	10.7
Latin America & Caribbean	0.01 [0.00, 0.01]	0.06 [0.01, 0.19]	9.6
N Africa & Middle East	0.04 [0.02, 0.06]	0.44 [0.22, 0.85]	7.4
C Europe, E Europe & C Asia	< 0.001	< 0.001	—
High-income	< 0.001	< 0.001	—
NTDs and malaria			
Global	14.48 [10.41, 20.64]	56.35 [26.01, 98.09]	20.4
Sub-Saharan Africa	6.54 [4.51, 9.42]	50.25 [21.56, 88.48]	11.5
South Asia	2.99 [2.01, 4.49]	3.54 [2.04, 5.91]	45.8
SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	2.28 [1.55, 3.24]	1.51 [0.88, 2.75]	60.1
Latin America & Caribbean	1.16 [0.84, 1.61]	0.47 [0.36, 0.63]	71.4
N Africa & Middle East	0.97 [0.68, 1.39]	0.53 [0.31, 0.93]	64.6
C Europe, E Europe & C Asia	0.24 [0.16, 0.35]	0.01 [0.01, 0.02]	94.5
High-income	0.30 [0.21, 0.44]	0.04 [0.03, 0.04]	89.3

Note. GBD 2023 all-age counts. NTD (excluding malaria) values are derived by subtraction and carry no interval.

Table S18
National Rankings of NTD and Malaria Burden, 2023, With Comparison to 2010

Country	Super-region	Rate 2023 [95% UI] / DALYs (thousands)	Rate 2010 / share of global (%)	Change in rate 2010–2023 (%)	SDI 2023
Highest age-standardised NTD (excl. malaria) DALY rate					
1. South Sudan	Sub-Saharan Africa	2,227.1	3,558.2	−37.4	0.379
2. Central African Republic	Sub-Saharan Africa	2,207.7	2,772.3	−20.4	0.259
3. Afghanistan	N Africa & Middle East	1,450.5	2,037.4	−28.8	0.334
4. Liberia	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,264.5	2,777.4	−54.5	0.383
5. Sierra Leone	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,229.1	1,738.3	−29.3	0.383
6. Democratic Republic of the Congo	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,000.4	2,328.2	−57.0	0.395
7. Nigeria	Sub-Saharan Africa	836.1	1,078.8	−22.5	0.512
8. Cameroon	Sub-Saharan Africa	811.2	1,460.0	−44.4	0.487
9. Chad	Sub-Saharan Africa	803.8	1,230.4	−34.7	0.239
10. Gabon	Sub-Saharan Africa	795.3	1,162.3	−31.6	0.631
Highest age-standardised malaria DALY rate					
1. Sierra Leone	Sub-Saharan Africa	8,237.2 [3,373.5, 13,703.9]	12,396.5	−33.6	0.383
2. Niger	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,902.2 [2,502.0, 11,188.8]	8,303.3	−28.9	0.203
3. Liberia	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,502.5 [2,231.5, 9,538.2]	8,109.7	−32.1	0.383
4. Nigeria	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,399.3 [1,959.3, 9,938.3]	7,657.1	−29.5	0.512
5. Benin	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,399.1 [2,541.4, 9,034.1]	6,907.9	−21.8	0.406
6. Burundi	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,229.5 [2,136.9, 9,216.8]	4,685.9	+11.6	0.307
7. Cameroon	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,210.5 [2,708.9, 8,436.4]	7,113.1	−26.7	0.487
8. Côte d'Ivoire	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,140.4 [3,361.4, 8,337.8]	9,322.0	−44.9	0.452
9. Equatorial Guinea	Sub-Saharan Africa	5,130.5 [2,960.1, 8,880.8]	6,034.5	−15.0	0.646
10. Burkina Faso	Sub-Saharan Africa	4,955.7 [3,311.1, 6,933.6]	10,080.2	−50.8	0.307
Largest absolute NTD (excl. malaria) DALYs (DALYs, thousands; share of global, %)					
1. India	South Asia	4,005	20.8	cumulative 20.8	0.607
2. Nigeria	Sub-Saharan Africa	2,098	10.9	cumulative 31.7	0.512
3. China	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	1,298	6.7	cumulative 38.5	0.728
4. Indonesia	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	1,239	6.4	cumulative 44.9	0.666
5. Democratic Republic of the Congo	Sub-Saharan Africa	828	4.3	cumulative 49.2	0.395
6. Brazil	Latin America & Caribbean	767	4.0	cumulative 53.2	0.684

Country	Super-region	Rate 2023 [95% UI] / DALYs (thousands)	Rate 2010 / share of global (%)	Change in rate 2010–2023 (%)	SDI 2023
7. Ethiopia	Sub-Saharan Africa	731	3.8	cumulative 57.0	0.394
8. Pakistan	South Asia	442	2.3	cumulative 59.3	0.513
9. Afghanistan	N Africa & Middle East	326	1.7	cumulative 61.0	0.334
10. Bangladesh	South Asia	276	1.4	cumulative 62.4	0.517
Largest absolute malaria DALYs (DALYs, thousands; share of global, %)					
1. Nigeria	Sub-Saharan Africa	16,627	32.2	cumulative 32.2	0.512
2. Democratic Republic of the Congo	Sub-Saharan Africa	6,459	12.5	cumulative 44.8	0.395
3. Niger	Sub-Saharan Africa	2,489	4.8	cumulative 49.6	0.203
4. Uganda	Sub-Saharan Africa	2,163	4.2	cumulative 53.8	0.442
5. Côte d'Ivoire	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,973	3.8	cumulative 57.6	0.452
6. Cameroon	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,918	3.7	cumulative 61.3	0.487
7. Mali	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,540	3.0	cumulative 64.3	0.285
8. Burkina Faso	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,491	2.9	cumulative 67.2	0.307
9. Mozambique	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,226	2.4	cumulative 69.6	0.342
10. Angola	Sub-Saharan Africa	1,109	2.2	cumulative 71.8	0.499

Note. Rates are age-standardised DALYs per 100 000. Changes for NTDs excluding malaria and for malaria are computed from GBD point estimates and have no interval; GBD-published changes with intervals for the NTD-and-malaria aggregate are in Table S19.

Table S19
Countries in Which Age-Standardised NTD or Malaria DALY Rates Rose Between 2010 and 2023

Country	Super-region	Outcome	ASR 2010	ASR 2023	Change (%) [95% UI where published]
NTDs and malaria, GBD-published change in ASR 2010–2023: decrease n = 78, uncertain n = 122, increase n = 4					
Nicaragua	Latin America & Caribbean	NTDs and malaria	363.2	744.7	105.0 [46.2, 178.8]
Fiji	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	NTDs and malaria	231.8	446.4	92.5 [62.7, 132.2]
Monaco	High-income	NTDs and malaria	27.2	51.3	88.8 [16.9, 242.3]
American Samoa	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	NTDs and malaria	118.1	184.6	56.2 [20.4, 91.4]
NTDs (excl. malaria): countries with a higher point-estimate rate in 2023 than 2010					
Nicaragua	Latin America & Caribbean	NTDs (excl. malaria)	362.1	727.7	+101.0
Fiji	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	NTDs (excl. malaria)	231.8	446.4	+92.6
Monaco	High-income	NTDs (excl. malaria)	27.2	51.3	+88.6
American Samoa	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	NTDs (excl. malaria)	118.1	184.6	+56.3
Guyana	Latin America & Caribbean	NTDs (excl. malaria)	289.9	370.3	+27.7
Seychelles	SE Asia, E Asia & Oceania	NTDs (excl. malaria)	194.2	237.0	+22.1
Syrian Arab Republic	N Africa & Middle East	NTDs (excl. malaria)	453.0	495.8	+9.4
Peru	Latin America & Caribbean	NTDs (excl. malaria)	317.9	346.1	+8.9
Ukraine	C Europe, E Europe & C Asia	NTDs (excl. malaria)	68.3	72.4	+6.0
Djibouti	Sub-Saharan Africa	NTDs (excl. malaria)	181.3	190.9	+5.3
Jamaica	Latin America & Caribbean	NTDs (excl. malaria)	148.6	155.2	+4.5
Republic of Korea	High-income	NTDs (excl. malaria)	66.5	68.1	+2.4
Mexico	Latin America & Caribbean	NTDs (excl. malaria)	147.1	147.3	+0.2
Malaria: countries with a higher point-estimate rate in 2023 than 2010 (2010 rate > 1 per 100 000)					
Nicaragua	Latin America & Caribbean	Malaria	1.1	17.0	+1449.9
Namibia	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	25.7	142.9	+456.1
Venezuela (Bolivarian Republic of)	Latin America & Caribbean	Malaria	13.6	59.3	+335.8
Djibouti	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	136.9	580.2	+323.8
Kenya	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	380.1	475.3	+25.1
Sudan	N Africa & Middle East	Malaria	439.5	513.8	+16.9
Madagascar	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	1,679.6	1,941.9	+15.6
Yemen	N Africa & Middle East	Malaria	647.2	747.8	+15.5
Burundi	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	4,685.9	5,229.5	+11.6

Country	Super-region	Outcome	ASR 2010	ASR 2023	Change (%) [95% UI where published]
Somalia	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	456.8	497.6	+8.9
Zambia	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	1,864.2	1,973.1	+5.8
Peru	Latin America & Caribbean	Malaria	3.9	4.1	+5.7
Eritrea	Sub-Saharan Africa	Malaria	398.1	409.9	+3.0

Note. ASR = age-standardised DALY rate per 100 000. Only the NTD-and-malaria aggregate has GBD-published country-level percent changes with uncertainty intervals; changes for the two components are computed from point estimates and should be read as descriptive.

Table S20

Cause-Specific National Leaders: Countries Contributing the Most NTD DALYs and Countries With the Highest Rates, 2023

Cause	Global DALYs (thousands)	Largest contributor (% of global)	Three largest contributors	Share of three largest (%)	Highest age-standardised rate (per 100 000)
Other neglected tropical diseases	5,137.5	India (24.0)	India; Nigeria; Pakistan	42.8	Sierra Leone (444.5)
Dengue	3,014.3	India (42.5)	India; Indonesia; Brazil	78.5	Nicaragua (474.6)
Schistosomiasis	2,070.4	Nigeria (33.2)	Nigeria; Ethiopia; DR Congo	49.7	Nigeria (334.3)
Intestinal nematode infections	1,538.2	Nigeria (10.3)	Nigeria; Indonesia; Viet Nam	26.2	Central African Republic (219.3)
Lymphatic filariasis	1,492.2	India (53.3)	India; Indonesia; Nigeria	63.8	Papua New Guinea (313.1)
Cysticercosis	1,181.5	India (15.9)	India; China; Mexico	37.5	Central African Republic (94.9)
Leishmaniasis	1,086.2	Afghanistan (26.8)	Afghanistan; Brazil; South Sudan	49.2	Afghanistan (1,365.3)
Food borne trematodiases	1,036.1	China (75.6)	China; Thailand; Viet Nam	84.4	Lao PDR (119.5)
Onchocerciasis	871.8	Democratic Republic of the Congo (42.3)	DR Congo; Nigeria; South Sudan	66.1	South Sudan (958.2)
Rabies	870.7	India (35.8)	India; Nigeria; Ethiopia	60.8	Ethiopia (78.3)
Yellow fever	310.0	Nigeria (26.7)	Nigeria; Ethiopia; Angola	48.7	Burundi (90.5)
Chagas disease	285.4	Brazil (58.2)	Brazil; Venezuela; Argentina	76.0	Bolivia (169.8)
Trachoma	145.4	Ethiopia (32.8)	Ethiopia; India; Nigeria	64.1	Ethiopia (100.0)
Cystic echinococcosis	97.0	China (18.0)	China; India; Ethiopia	38.5	South Sudan (8.5)
African trypanosomiasis	85.1	Democratic Republic of the Congo (33.3)	DR Congo; Central African Republic; Guinea	70.6	Central African Republic (389.0)
Leprosy	18.6	India (43.9)	India; Brazil; Indonesia	69.6	Kiribati (2.8)

Note. Sum of 204 country-level GBD 2023 all-age counts. Causes with fewer than 1 000 global DALYs (Ebola, Guinea worm disease, Zika virus) omitted. "Other NTDs" is the GBD residual category.

Table S21

Stability of Spatial Clustering, 1990–2023, and External Validation Against WHO Surveillance Series

Series	Moran's I / ρ	*z*	*p*	High–High (n)	Low–Low (n)	Spatial outliers (n)
A. Spatial autocorrelation of log(1 + age-standardised DALY rate)						
NTDs (excl. malaria), 1990	0.74	20.1	<0.0001	42	43	0
NTDs (excl. malaria), 2010	0.75	20.2	<0.0001	47	39	0
NTDs (excl. malaria), 2023	0.71	19.2	<0.0001	48	39	0
Malaria, 1990	0.72	19.5	<0.0001	45	54	1
Malaria, 2010	0.75	20.4	<0.0001	40	49	1
Malaria, 2023	0.79	21.4	<0.0001	42	62	1
B. Agreement between GBD and WHO/UN SDG country series (Spearman rank correlation)						
NTD DALY rate vs people requiring NTD interventions per 100 000, 2010	ρ = 0.84	—	<0.0001	n = 180	—	—
Malaria DALY rate vs WHO malaria incidence per 1000 at risk, 2010	ρ = 0.96	—	<0.0001	n = 96	—	—
NTD DALY rate vs people requiring NTD interventions per 100 000, 2023	ρ = 0.81	—	<0.0001	n = 170	—	—
Malaria DALY rate vs WHO malaria incidence per 1000 at risk, 2023	ρ = 0.94	—	<0.0001	n = 79	—	—

Note. Panel A: row-standardised k = 6 nearest-neighbour weights, 9 999 permutations, LISA clusters at Benjamini–Hochberg q<0.05 (n = 203 countries with geometry). Panel B: WHO-reported people requiring interventions against NTDs (SDG 3.3.5) expressed per 100 000 population; WHO malaria incidence per 1 000 population at risk (SDG 3.3.3), endemic countries only.

Table S22
Additional Sensitivity Analyses of the Financing Association and the Theil Decomposition

Analysis	NTDs (excl. malaria)	Malaria
A. Preferred two-way fixed-effects estimate, % difference per 10-percentage-point external share [95% CI] (observations)		
Primary specification (2007–2022)	−0.64 [−2.39, 1.14] (2,287)	−6.32 [−10.84, −1.57] (1,187)
Panel extended through 2023	−0.32 [−2.13, 1.53] (2,429)	−6.97 [−11.28, −2.45] (1,262)
Excluding observations without matching raw UHC or LDI records	−0.45 [−2.17, 1.29] (2,101)	No observations affected
Omitting UHC effective coverage	−0.78 [−2.44, 0.91]	−6.59 [−11.62, −1.28]
Country-clustered rather than Driscoll–Kraay standard errors	CI includes zero	−6.32 [−17.14, 5.91]
B. Theil T decomposition, 2023		
Primary: GBD populations, non-zero rates (NTDs n = 204; malaria n = 86)	0.43; between 64.0%	1.34; between 79.3%
World Bank populations, non-zero rates (NTDs n = 199; malaria n = 86)	0.43; between 63.4%	1.34; between 78.9%
World Bank populations, zero rates retained (n = 199)	0.43; between 63.4% (no zero rates)	1.88; between 83.7%

Note. Malaria estimates are percentage differences in (1 + age-standardised DALY rate). UHC = universal health coverage effective-coverage index; LDI = lag-distributed income per capita. In the Theil T with zero rates, the limiting term $0 \times \log(0)$ is set to zero.

Table S23

Between-Country and Within-Country Associations of External Health Financing With Age-Standardised DALY Rates (Correlated Random-Effects Decomposition)

Exposure — component	% difference [95% CI]	*p*	Observations	Countries
NTDs (excl. malaria)				
External share, per 10 percentage points — within-country	−0.64 [−2.43, 1.18]	0.49	2,287	153
External share, per 10 percentage points — between-country	−4.99 [−11.25, 1.71]	0.14	2,287	153
External share, per 10 percentage points — difference (contextual)	−4.38 [−10.82, 2.52]	0.21	2,287	153
External expenditure per capita, per doubling — within-country	−0.45 [−1.63, 0.75]	0.46	2,287	153
External expenditure per capita, per doubling — between-country	−1.36 [−8.29, 6.09]	0.71	2,287	153
External expenditure per capita, per doubling — difference (contextual)	−0.91 [−7.92, 6.62]	0.81	2,287	153
Malaria				
External share, per 10 percentage points — within-country	−6.32 [−16.82, 5.50]	0.28	1,187	77
External share, per 10 percentage points — between-country	18.25 [−13.46, 61.58]	0.29	1,187	77
External share, per 10 percentage points — difference (contextual)	26.23 [−9.49, 76.04]	0.17	1,187	77
External expenditure per capita, per doubling — within-country	−4.36 [−17.87, 11.37]	0.57	1,187	77
External expenditure per capita, per doubling — between-country	3.00 [−25.61, 42.60]	0.86	1,187	77
External expenditure per capita, per doubling — difference (contextual)	7.70 [−24.36, 53.33]	0.68	1,187	77

Note. Correlated random-effects (Mundlak) model with year effects, the five covariates of the preferred model and their country means; country-clustered standard errors. The within-country component is the coefficient on the time-varying exposure; the between-country component adds the coefficient on its country mean; the difference tests whether the two are equal. Malaria estimates refer to (1 + rate). Per-capita exposure is log(1 + external health expenditure per capita), so a doubling refers to expenditure plus US$1.

Table S24

Malaria Mortality as an Alternative Outcome: Two-Way Fixed-Effects Associations With External Health Financing, Malaria-Endemic Countries, 2007–2022

Outcome	Exposure	% difference, Driscoll–Kraay [95% CI]	*p*	% difference, country-clustered [95% CI]	*p*	Observations
Malaria deaths, log(1 + ASR)	Per 10 percentage points	−6.30 [−10.96, −1.38]	0.013	−6.30 [−14.06, 2.17]	0.14	1,133
Malaria DALYs, log(1 + ASR)	Per 10 percentage points	−6.32 [−10.85, −1.56]	0.0098	−6.32 [−17.14, 5.91]	0.30	1,187
Malaria deaths, log(1 + ASR)	Per doubling of expenditure + US$1	−8.91 [−14.32, −3.16]	0.0028	−8.91 [−16.93, −0.11]	0.047	1,133
Malaria DALYs, log(1 + ASR)	Per doubling of expenditure + US$1	−4.36 [−10.57, 2.27]	0.19	−4.36 [−18.28, 11.92]	0.58	1,187

Note. Preferred specification (country and year fixed effects; covariates as in Table S4) with the GBD 2023 age-standardised malaria death rate as outcome, 77 malaria-endemic low- and middle-income countries. Exposures lagged 2 years. The DALY rows repeat the primary outcome on the same countries for comparison.

Table S25
Derivation of the Analytical Samples

Sample	Included	Excluded (reason)	Analyses
A. Descriptive, inequality and spatial analyses			
GBD 2023 countries and territories	204	—	Burden, trends, rankings, concentration index, SII (Tables 1, S15a–S20)
With non-zero malaria rate, 2023	86	118 with zero malaria burden	Malaria Theil T (Tables 2, S15b)
With Natural Earth geometry	203	1 (Tokelau)	Moran’s I and LISA (Tables 2, S21)
With WHO/UN SDG series, 2023	170 (NTDs); 79 (malaria)	Non-reporting or non-endemic countries	External triangulation (Table S21)
B. Financing analyses (countries outside the GBD high-income super-region, 2007–2022)			
Financing frame	168 countries; 2,688 country-years	36 high-income countries	Missing-data profile (Table S10a)
NTD panel sample	153 countries; 2,287 country-years	401 incomplete country-years, including all years for 15 countries*	Panel models (Tables 3, S3, S4, S10b, S23)
Malaria panel sample	77 countries; 1,187 country-years	90 non-endemic countries; 1 endemic country without complete records	Panel models (Tables 3, S23, S24)
Balanced spatial panels	130 (NTDs) and 71 (malaria) countries; 16 years	Countries with any missing year	Spatial panel models (Tables 3, S12)
2023 cross-section	145 (NTDs); 58 (malaria)	Countries with missing 2023 covariates	Between-country models and GWR (Tables 3, S6a–b)
Scenario models	153 countries	Countries without external-expenditure data	Projections (Tables 4, S8, S14)

Note. *American Samoa, Bermuda, Cook Islands, Guam, Montenegro, Nicaragua, Niue, North Korea, Northern Mariana Islands, Puerto Rico, Slovakia, Taiwan (province of China), Tokelau, Türkiye and US Virgin Islands. Incomplete records lacked at least one lagged financing exposure or covariate after the within-country interpolation rule; outcomes were never imputed. LMIC denotes countries outside the GBD high-income super-region.

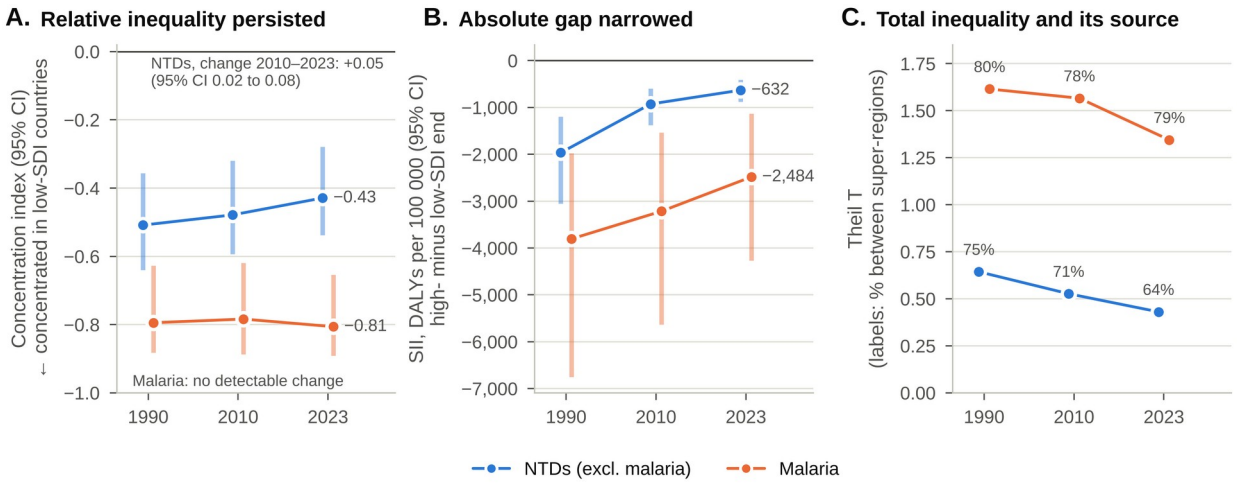
Table S26
Characteristics of the Panel Analysis Samples, 2007–2022

Variable	NTD sample: mean (SD)	NTD sample: median [IQR]	Malaria sample: mean (SD)	Malaria sample: median [IQR]
NTD age-standardised DALY rate, per 100 000	388.2 (536.9)	212.8 [103.5–501.7]	636.0 (648.0)	485.4 [279.4–790.6]
Malaria age-standardised DALY rate, per 100 000	1,077.0 (2,202.7)	1.4 [0.0–798.6]	2,075.0 (2,698.0)	658.7 [25.3–3,363.6]
External health expenditure, % of current health expenditure (lag 2 years)	12.3 (16.5)	4.2 [0.5–19.2]	18.5 (17.0)	13.7 [4.2–28.9]
External health expenditure per capita, US$ (lag 2 years)	17.2 (48.4)	4.9 [1.2–12.4]	11.5 (14.4)	6.9 [2.9–14.3]
Domestic government health expenditure per capita, US$ (lag 2 years)	183.1 (270.6)	74.7 [14.0–220.9]	59.8 (99.8)	15.3 [6.9–61.0]
Lag-distributed income per capita, international $	10,720.6 (14,387.5)	6,932.3 [2,745.0–13,103.7]	5,101.1 (5,090.4)	3,047.6 [1,840.1–6,623.6]
UHC effective coverage index (0–100)	50.3 (12.5)	50.0 [42.2–57.7]	46.4 (10.8)	46.9 [40.2–52.4]
Basic sanitation coverage, %	67.3 (29.0)	78.9 [42.3–93.3]	46.9 (24.9)	45.0 [25.2–67.3]
Basic drinking-water coverage, %	82.9 (17.3)	90.2 [71.0–96.6]	72.2 (17.4)	72.7 [59.0–88.1]

Note. NTD sample: 153 countries, 2,287 country-years; malaria sample: 77 malaria-endemic countries, 1,187 country-years. Statistics are over country-years. Financial variables in current US$; LDI = lag-distributed income; UHC = universal health coverage. Distributions of rates and expenditure are right-skewed, which motivates the log transformations in Table S11.

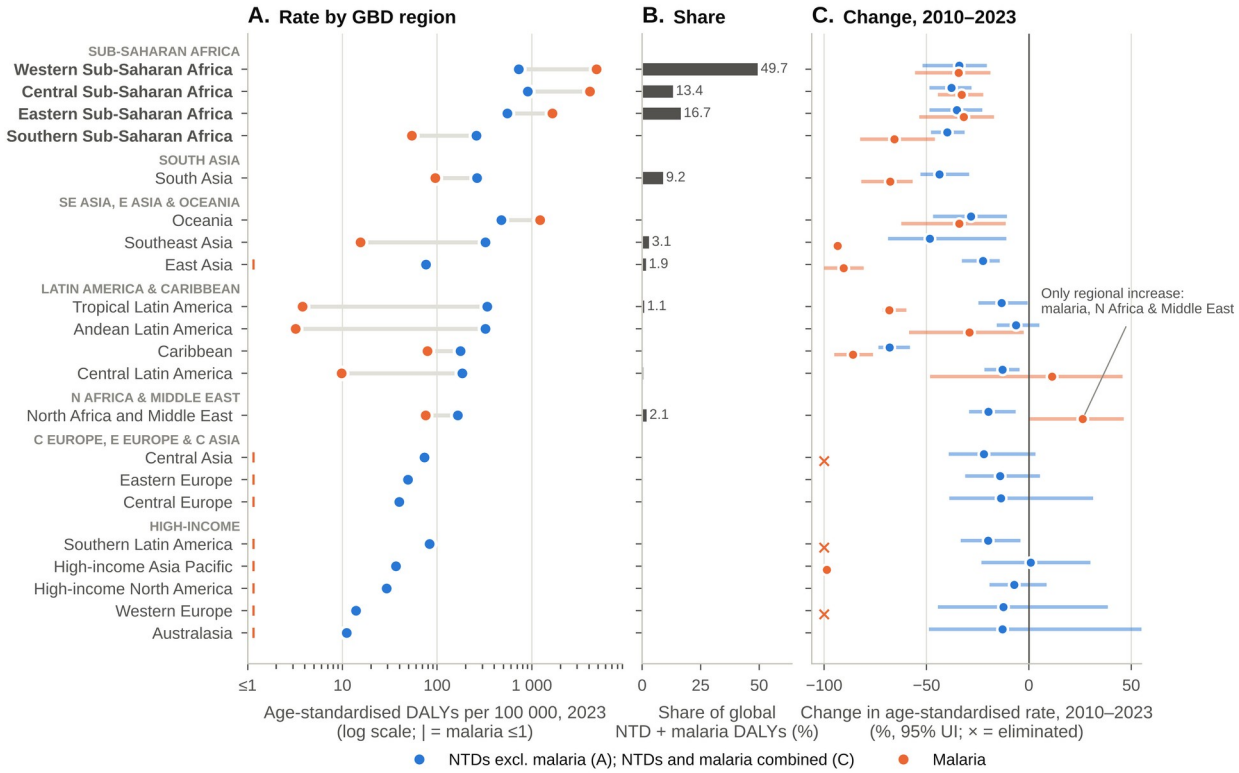
5. Supplementary figures

Figure S1: Socioeconomic inequality in age-standardised DALY rates by SDI, 1990, 2010 and 2023



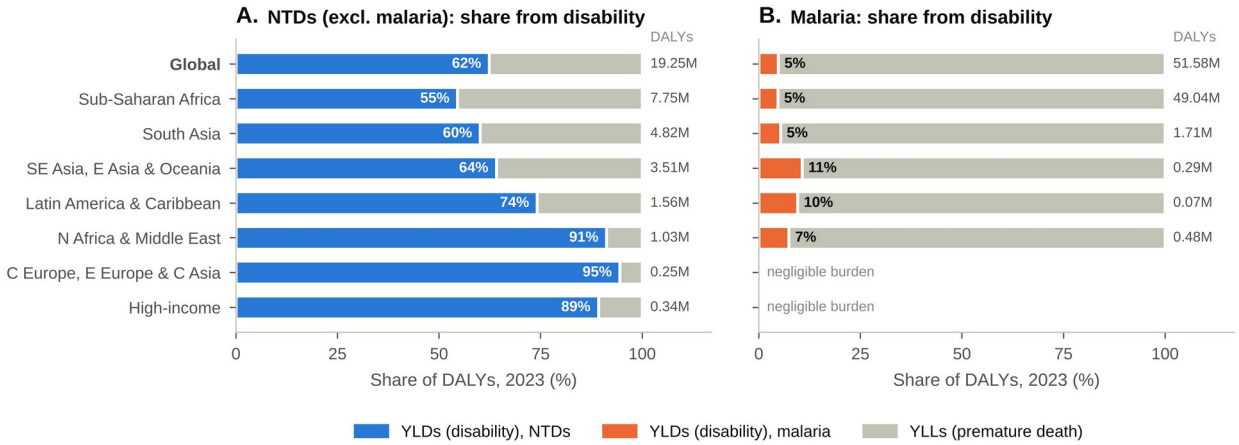
(A) Concentration index with 95% bootstrap CI; negative values indicate concentration in low-SDI countries. (B) Slope index of inequality (SII), the modelled difference in DALYs per 100 000 between the highest-SDI and lowest-SDI ends of the distribution, with 95% CI. (C) Theil T; labels give the percentage of inequality between super-regions. Countries weighted by population and ranked by SDI of the same year (n = 204). Absolute gaps narrowed while relative concentration of malaria was unchanged.

Figure S2: Burden and change in the 21 GBD regions



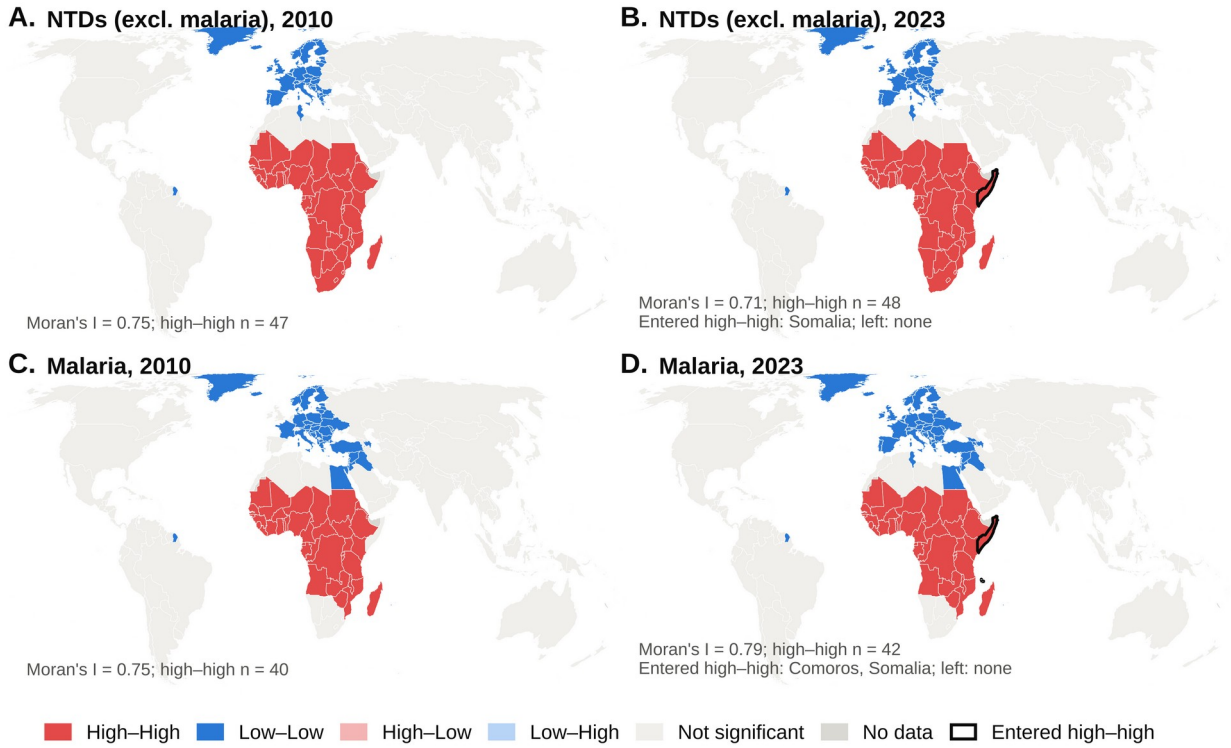
(A) Age-standardised DALY rate per 100 000 in 2023 for NTDs excluding malaria and for malaria (log scale; regions grouped by super-region; sub-Saharan African regions in bold). (B) Share of global combined NTD-and-malaria DALYs. (C) GBD-published percentage change in age-standardised rate, 2010–2023, with 95% UI, for the NTD-and-malaria aggregate and for malaria; × marks regions where malaria burden fell to zero.

Figure S3: Years lived with disability and years of life lost as shares of DALYs, 2023



Coloured segments show the YLD share of DALYs for (A) NTDs excluding malaria and (B) malaria, by super-region; grey segments show YLLs. Totals are all-age DALYs. Most NTD burden is disability, whereas malaria burden is almost entirely premature death.

Figure S4: Local spatial clusters of age-standardised DALY rates, 2010 and 2023



Local indicators of spatial association on log(1 + rate) with six-nearest-neighbour weights, 9999 permutations and Benjamini–Hochberg false-discovery rate below 5%. Black outlines mark countries that entered a high–high cluster between 2010 and 2023.

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